

Devtools marketing swipe file, 2016 to 2026

AS OF: 2026-10-06. OWNER: ROHIT. RESEARCH, TIER 5 IN THE AUTHORITY ORDER. AN IDEA BANK FOR ONEFLUX, NOT A PLAN; NOTHING HERE IS APPROVED SPEND.

The moves that paid off most over the decade gave engineers something useful that wasn't the product (a manual, a method, a magazine, a free tool) and let the product follow. The companies that named a category or a job title (observability, platform engineering, analytics engineer, AI engineer) owned the conversation by the time analysts arrived. Proof that held up was reproducible, and proof that didn't (Devin's Upwork video) cost more than it earned. In enterprise sales, developer usage was the evidence and governance sold upward was the revenue (Snyk, HashiCorp, Cursor). The newest shift is that agents now read the docs and provision the free tier: 66% of Mintlify docs traffic and 80% of new Neon databases came from agents, and Tailwind lost about 40% of its docs traffic to them. The second pass adds a quieter pattern: the cheapest enterprise distribution runs through channels the buyer already pays for, such as cloud commitments, the Jira bill, the systems integrator on site and the footer of the tool's own output.

How to read it. Each entry has the same six fields. Evidence is tagged `company-reported`, `third-party`, `inferred` or `unverified`. Fit is how well the move transfers to an enterprise-sold AI SDLC platform launching on 19 Jan 2027. "Less known" marks moves a well-read devtools marketer probably hasn't seen. Entries 1 to 47 came from the first research pass and 48 to 72 from a second pass on marketplaces, product loops, education and India, field marketing, and brand. The moves that fit the current calendar and budget are at the end. Everything researched and discarded, with the reason, is in the appendix.

This file covers the wider devtools decade. Direct AI-coding competitors from Aug 2024 to Aug 2026 (Cognition, Augment, Greptile, CodeRabbit, Humanitec, Harness and others) have their own 25-item swipe file in `sources/research/competitor-gtm/TBSP-Competitive-GTM-and-Marketing-Guide-Plain-Language-Aug2024-Aug2026.docx`. Where an entry here overlaps, it says so.

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#	COMPANY	THE MOVE	YEAR	GROUP	FIT	LESS KNOWN
1	Stripe	Docs that run on the reader's own key; dated, pinned API versions	2011 to 2022	Docs	High	
2	Twilio	"Ask Your Developer" billboard, later a book	c.2016, 2021	Docs	Medium	
3	Tailwind	Free docs as the shop window for a paid kit, and the 2026 collapse	2017 to 2026	Docs	Medium	Yes
4	Mintlify	Docs written for agents: llms.txt, Markdown, MCP	2025 to 2026	Docs	High	Yes
5	Algolia	DocSearch: free search on others' docs for a logo	2016	Docs	Medium	Yes
6	PagerDuty	Open-sourced its internal incident-response manual	2017	Docs	High	Yes
7	Supabase	Launch Week, every quarter	2021 onward	Launch	High	
8	Resend	Open-source companion first, then a five-day launch week	2022 to 2025	Launch	High	Yes
9	Linear	The changelog as the marketing channel	2019 onward	Launch	High	
10	Cognition	Devin's demo-video launch with a SWE-bench number, and the debunk	2024	Launch	Medium	
11	Anthropic	Claude Code: heavy internal use, then a "research preview"	2024 to 2025	Launch	High	
12	Vercel	v0 waitlist opened on a fixed date with pricing set	2023	Launch	Medium	
13	HashiCorp	Open-source downloads as the target-account list	2014 to 2021	Open source	Medium	
14	Sentry	Wrote a licence, named "Fair Source", started the Open Source Pledge	2023 to 2024	Open source	Medium	Yes
15	Grafana	"Big tent": connect to every source, competitors included	2022	Open source	High	Yes
16	n8n	Self-hosting plus a user-written template library	2022 to 2025	Open source	High	Yes
17	Temporal	Open-source engine plus a small customer-led conference	2020 to 2023	Open source	Medium	Yes
18	GitLab	Public handbook and a free Remote Playbook	2020 to 2021	Open source	Medium	
19	Stripe	Increment magazine	2017 to 2021	Content	Medium	
20	PostHog	"Product for Engineers" newsletter about the craft	2023 to 2025	Content	High	
21	Linear	"The Linear Method"	undated	Content	High	
22	Fly.io	Long Hacker News posts, including "Reliability: It's not great"	2020 to 2025	Content	Medium	

#	COMPANY	THE MOVE	YEAR	GROUP	FIT	LESS KNOWN
23	Honeycomb	Founder named "observability", then a free O'Reilly book	2016 to 2026	Content	High	
24	Basecamp	Shape Up: a paid workshop as the prototype for a free book	2019	Content	High	Yes
25	Sourcegraph	A named engineer's thesis essay before the product post	2023	Content	High	Yes
26	Sentry	Bought the podcast it sponsored and removed the ads	2023	Content	Low	Yes
27	dbt Labs	Slack first, conference second, and a named job title	2016 to 2022	Community	High	
28	Humanitec	PlatformCon and platformengineering.org as a category play	2022 to 2025	Community	High	
29	Vercel	Personalised, shareable Next.js Conf tickets	2019 to 2022	Community	Medium	Yes
30	swyx / AI Engineer	An essay names the role, an application-only conference sells it	2023 to 2026	Community	High	
31	MLOps Community	A neutral, sponsor-funded community	2020 to 2026	Community	Medium	Yes
32	GitHub	Copilot free for students and maintainers, then Copilot Free	2022, 2024	Pricing	Medium	
33	Cursor	A \$20 plan engineers can expense, as the way into enterprise	2023 to 2026	Pricing	High	
34	Tailscale	Free plan rebuilt around the step from one user to two	2023	Pricing	High	Yes
35	CodeRabbit	Free AI review on every public repo, plus a \$10M OSS pledge	2023 to 2026	Pricing	High	
36	Neon	A free tier built for other companies' agents	2024 to 2025	Pricing	High	Yes
37	Snyk	Developers adopt free, the CISO buys governance	2015 to 2021	Enterprise	High	
38	Palantir, OpenAI	Forward-deployed engineers as the sales motion	2025	Enterprise	High	
39	GitLab, AWS	Launching off the first Gartner Magic Quadrant for AI Code Assistants	2024	Enterprise	High	Yes
40	Jellyfish	A vendor-owned annual survey for engineering leaders	2020 to 2025	Enterprise	High	Yes
41	Puppet, DORA, Google	Owning the yardstick: the State of DevOps report	2013 to 2024	Enterprise	High	
42	GitHub	A randomised trial as Copilot's launch number	2022, 2024	Proof	High	
43	Augment Code	#1 on SWE-bench Verified, with the benchmark's limits in the same post	2025	Proof	Medium	
44	Greptile	A benchmark that names every competitor	2025	Proof	Medium	
45	Bun	A 1.0 post built as a wall of head-to-head benchmarks	2023	Proof	Medium	
46	GitLab	Livestreamed its own database-loss recovery	2017	Proof	High	

#	COMPANY	THE MOVE	YEAR	GROUP	FIT	LESS KNOWN
47	Cloudflare	Same-day, code-level post-mortems	2019 to 2025	Proof	High	
48	CrowdStrike, Datadog	Billing against the buyer's committed cloud spend	2018 to 2024	Marketplace	High	
49	Atlassian	Marketplace apps that live where the tickets are	2012 to 2024	Marketplace	High	
50	Infosys, Cognizant	The systems integrator as customer zero and channel	2024 to 2025	Marketplace	High	Yes
51	Upstash	Context7, a free MCP server that markets a database company	2025 to 2026	Marketplace	High	Yes
52	Statuspage	"Powered by" footer on every customer's status page	2013 to 2016	Product loop	High	Yes
53	Anthropic	Claude Code's default co-author trailer and PR footer	2025 to 2026	Product loop	High	
54	Vercel, Netlify	Preview links that bring non-developers in	2016, 2022	Product loop	High	
55	Postman, Netlify, StackBlitz	Buttons and embeds in other people's docs	2016 to 2024	Product loop	Medium	
56	Microsoft	AI Odyssey, a one-month credential sprint in India	2024	Education	High	Yes
57	CNCF	Kubestronaut, a named title for five certifications	2024 to 2026	Education	High	Yes
58	MongoDB	An India student pipeline through government channels	2023 to 2026	Education	Medium	Yes
59	WeMakeDevs	Sponsored tracks in a creator-run hackathon	2023 to 2026	Education	High	Yes
60	Codeium (Windsurf)	A free, vendor-taught DeepLearning.AI course	2025	Education	High	Yes
61	Cursor	Volunteer ambassadors, an India roadshow, a rupee plan	2025 to 2026	Education	High	Yes
62	MongoDB, Snowflake	Voucher-only events across three Indian cities	2022 to 2026	Field	High	Yes
63	Confluent	Kafka Summit renamed for the category, taken to Bengaluru	2016 to 2025	Field	High	Yes
64	LeadDev	Renting a room of VPs of Engineering	ongoing	Field	High	
65	Reo.dev, Common Room	Developer-signal ABM	2023 to 2025	Field	Medium	Yes
66	GitHub	A commissioned Forrester TEI study as the CFO slide	2022 to 2025	Field	High	
67	Atlassian, GitHub, Snowflake, Pulumi	Takeout packages built around a deadline	2023 to 2026	Field	Medium	Yes
68	MongoDB	AMP: tool plus method plus engineers	2024 to 2025	Field	High	Yes
69	Cloudflare	A launch date that matches the product, then a waitlist	2018, 2019	Brand	Medium	

#	COMPANY	THE MOVE	YEAR	GROUP	FIT	LESS KNOWN
70	GitHub	The Arctic Code Vault badge	2019 to 2020	Brand	Medium	Yes
71	Anthropic, PostHog	A "thinking" cap pop-up, and the real cost of merch	2025 to 2026	Brand	High	Yes
72	OpenAI and peers	AGENTS.md, a neutral file name as a standard	2025	Brand	High	

1. Docs and reference as the marketing

1. Stripe: docs that run on the reader's own key, and an API that never breaks (2011 to 2022)

THE MOVE

Every code sample in Stripe's docs carries the reader's own test API key, so a copied sample runs against their account on the first paste. Content adapts to the reader's country and the features they use. Stripe dates each API version (2017-05-24 style), pins every account to the version it started on, and generates the changelog on each deploy. Internally, documentation sits on the engineering career ladder and is graded in performance reviews. In 2022 it open-sourced its docs framework, Markdoc.

WHY IT WORKED

The docs are the trial. A sample that works first time is the demo, and date-pinned versions are what let a CTO treat a vendor as infrastructure.

EVIDENCE

Compatibility kept with every API version since 2011, across "almost a hundred backwards-incompatible upgrades" in six years company-reported. The career-ladder practice comes from a former Stripe docs manager, via Mintlify third-party. No traffic or conversion number exists.

COST

Not documented. The old docs platform held hundreds of pages maintained by many teams.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Make the December self-serve quickstart run against the reader's own sandbox, with their repo already filled in. Publish a dated, pinned versioning policy for agent behaviour on launch day, because the enterprise fear is a model change silently breaking a pipeline.

SOURCES

[How Stripe builds interactive docs with Markdoc, 13 Sep 2022](#); [APIs as infrastructure, 5 Aug 2017](#); [Mintlify on Stripe docs, 10 Nov 2023](#)

2. Twilio: "Ask Your Developer" (billboard c.2016, book 2021)

THE MOVE

Billboards around San Francisco said only "Ask Your Developer", with no product description. Jeff Lawson later turned the line into a Harper Business book in January 2021.

WHY IT WORKED

One line spoke to two readers. Executives heard "your engineers already know this vendor", and developers heard "every developer uses Twilio". Developer adoption became the executive's reason to buy.

EVIDENCE

Widely discussed in tech press and podcasts third-party, qualitative. No campaign metrics found. The billboard year is unverified.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Write one line aimed at the VP Engineering that points at their own engineers, such as "Ask your on-call engineer". Test it on LinkedIn to GCC heads before spending on outdoor in Bengaluru or on the 101.

SOURCES

[Raman Sharma, 23 Nov 2021](#); [TechCrunch, 15 Jan 2021](#)

3. Tailwind: free docs selling a paid kit, and what happened when agents took the traffic (2017 to 2026)

THE MOVE

Tailwind CSS was free and open source, with heavy investment in docs and a build live-streamed in public. The docs then sold the Refactoring UI book (Dec 2018) and Tailwind UI, a paid component kit (early access 26 Feb 2020).

WHY IT WORKED

Developers open framework docs every day. A paid product sold from inside them costs almost nothing to acquire customers for.

EVIDENCE

Tailwind UI was "about to cross \$2 million in revenue" five months after launch [company-reported](#). In January 2026 Adam Wathan said docs traffic was down about 40% from early 2023, revenue was down close to 80%, and 75% of engineering had been let go, because AI assistants answer without sending readers to the docs [company-reported](#).

COST

A small team; three hired developers named in 2020 [company-reported](#).

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Use docs to sell, but put the conversion point inside the product or the agent's output, such as a footer on a generated spec ("made with OneFlux, run it on your repo"). Human page views are a shrinking way in.

SOURCES

Adam Wathan, 2 Aug 2020; [tailwindcss.com PR #2388](#), 6 Jan 2026

4. Mintlify: docs written for agents as well as people (2025 to 2026)

THE MOVE

Mintlify serves llms.txt, llms-full.txt, plain Markdown for every page and a hosted MCP server for every customer's docs. It reports agent and human traffic separately, and tells customers to measure how much work agents waste on the docs.

WHY IT WORKED

The coding agent is now often the reader that picks the tool. Docs an agent can read cleanly get recommended and wired into code.

EVIDENCE

Agents were 66% of measured traffic across Mintlify-hosted docs in July 2026 (213M agent requests against 105M human page loads), up from 15.2% at the start of 2026 [company-reported](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Ship llms.txt, Markdown docs and a docs MCP server with the December entry point. Test by having Claude Code and Codex install and configure OneFlux unaided, and publish the result as a launch asset. Goosewin's docs and cookbook scope should include this.

SOURCES

Mintlify, [State of docs traffic](#), 29 Jul 2026

5. Algolia: DocSearch, free search on other people's docs in exchange for a logo (2016)

THE MOVE

Algolia engineers built search for open-source documentation and offered it by sending pull requests to projects such as Bootstrap and jQuery. Hosting and crawling are free if "Search by Algolia" shows beside the results; removing the logo needs a paid plan. In October 2023 it opened to all technical docs sites.

WHY IT WORKED

Developers search framework docs many times a day, so the logo sits in front of buyers on pages Algolia never paid for. Every search is a live product demo.

EVIDENCE

8,000+ sites and 170M searches a month company-reported, Oct 2023. The docsearch repo has 4,375 stars third-party, GitHub API, Oct 2026.

COST

Algolia pays crawl and hosting; amount not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Offer free agent review of specs and design proposals on public RFC processes (Kubernetes KEPs, Rust RFCs, Apache project proposals), each comment carrying a one-line attribution. It puts the Spec module where senior engineers read.

SOURCES

Algolia, 17 Oct 2023; [DocSearch program terms](#)

6. PagerDuty: open-sourced its own incident-response manual (2017)

THE MOVE

PagerDuty published its internal on-call and incident-response documents as response.pagerduty.com and a GitHub repo under Apache 2.0: severity levels SEV-1 to SEV-5, call etiquette, the incident commander role, postmortems and security response. Internal details were stripped. Sibling guides on postmortems, stakeholder comms and going on-call followed.

WHY IT WORKED

Teams that fork the process take on its vocabulary and roles, which match the product. When they buy tooling, PagerDuty already fits how they work. The Apache licence lets enterprises adopt it without legal review.

EVIDENCE

1,053 stars and 219 forks third-party, GitHub API, Oct 2026. Covered by SD Times on 4 Jan 2017 third-party.

COST

Editing existing internal docs for public use; not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Publish "how we run agents across spec, code, review and on-call" under Apache 2.0 at launch: roles, escalation, when a human must approve. GCC platform teams can fork it and present it internally as their own policy. This is cheap and directly sells the On-call and Review modules.

SOURCES

SD Times, 4 Jan 2017; response.pagerduty.com/about

2. Launch mechanics

7. Supabase: Launch Week, every quarter (2021 onward)

THE MOVE

Supabase turned launch day into a week with one major release a day, first in March 2021, repeated about every three months. The package is now fixed: five main-stage launches Monday to Friday, a "build stage" of smaller releases, a 10-day hackathon from the Friday, and meetups in 40+ cities.

WHY IT WORKED

It recreates Demo Day pressure inside the company, so things ship. The market gets five days of news instead of one spike, and a fixed calendar lets press, partners and community plan around it.

EVIDENCE

Managed databases grew 47% month on month for 18 months, at 30 staff, by Nov 2021 company-reported. June 2026: \$10.5B valuation, nearly 10M developers, over 60% of new databases started by AI tools third-party, TechCrunch. Launch Week can't be separated from other causes inferred.

COST

Not documented. The whole company works to the deadline.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Make Tue 19 Jan the first day of a launch week, one module a day: Spec, Code, Review, On-call, with governance on the last day. Put the April 2027 repeat on the calendar now. Continue ran a launch week too (see the competitor guide, entry 05).

SOURCES

Supabase, [How we launch](#), 26 Nov 2021; [Supabase Launch Week](#); [TechCrunch](#), 5 Jun 2026

8. Resend: open-source companion first, then a launch week on a small budget (2022 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Before the paid email API was public, the founders released React Email (Dec 2022), an open-source library for building email templates that works with any provider. Resend stayed behind a waitlist until June 2023. Later launch weeks ran "5 features in 5 days": each feature user-requested, built weeks ahead behind a flag, tested by the users who asked, with a blog post, social posts, a video and a waitlist email each day.

WHY IT WORKED

The free tool solved the step before the paid one and led naturally to it. Building behind flags made launch day a flag flip, and the users who asked for each feature talked about it first.

EVIDENCE

Launch tweet past 1M views (Jan 2023), 1,000 paying customers by Dec 2023, 3M users by Jun 2026 company-reported. React Email has 19,812 stars third-party, GitHub API. A 45% rise in impressions over the previous launch week company-reported.

COST

Low. Videos were shot with a tripod, a basic microphone and natural light company-reported.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Release a provider-neutral open spec format, usable with any coding agent, before launch, so OneFlux is the best place to run it. Choose launch-week features from the design-partner request log and have that partner co-sign the day's post. Build everything behind flags in December.

SOURCES

Resend, [How we got here](#); [Resend, Launch Week behind the scenes](#), 11 Apr 2025; [GitHub](#), [resend/react-email](#)

9. Linear: the changelog as the marketing channel (2019 onward)

THE MOVE

From April 2019 Linear published a public changelog weekly or every two weeks: one to three headline changes with screenshots or video, small fixes grouped below. Writing rotates around the team. It sits in the main site navigation and goes out on X, by email and in the app.

WHY IT WORKED

Visible, steady shipping is the cheapest proof a team is fast, and buyers and recruits both look for it. The content reuses work already done.

EVIDENCE

50+ changelogs and 1,000+ followers in the first year company-reported. 192 entries from April 2019 to March 2025, with only two 30-day gaps third-party.

COST

A few hours a week, rotated inferred.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Start a public weekly changelog with the 31 Oct website and keep it in the top nav. An unbroken weekly record answers the enterprise question about whether a young vendor will still be shipping in a year.

SOURCES

[Linear, Startups write changelogs, 18 May 2020](#); [Changebot, 7 Mar 2025](#)

10. Cognition: Devin's launch video, the benchmark, and the debunk (2024)

THE MOVE

Cognition came out of stealth on 12 Mar 2024 with a video of "the first AI software engineer", a \$21M Series A, founder credentials, about 15 endorsement posts and a waitlist. Three days later a technical report claimed 13.86% on a 25% subset of SWE-bench against a prior best of 1.96%, with the harness open-sourced and caveats listed. A follow-up video claimed Devin did paid Upwork jobs.

WHY IT WORKED

A new category name, one benchmark figure and scarce access produced a lot of social proof in days. Publishing the harness made the number checkable.

EVIDENCE

Valuation went from \$350M to about \$2B within about a month; ARR from \$1M (Sep 2024) to \$73M (Jun 2025) third-party, Contrary. An engineer showed the Upwork video misrepresented the task, and Answer.AI later found Devin solved 3 of 20 tasks third-party.

COST

Credibility. Cognition moved to "far from perfect" wording third-party.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Use a category claim and a number, but make every demo in the Goosewin launch film reproducible: repo, prompt, time taken and failures, said on screen. Analysts and buyers will test it, and a debunk outlasts a launch. The competitor guide covers Cognition's later GA and annual-review moves (entries 03 and 10).

SOURCES

[Cognition, Introducing Devin, 12 Mar 2024](#); [Cognition, SWE-bench technical report, 15 Mar 2024](#); [Answer.AI, 8 Jan 2025](#); [Contrary Research](#)

11. Anthropic: Claude Code, heavy internal use and then a "research preview" (2024 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Claude Code started as an internal terminal prototype in late 2024 and spread inside Anthropic without a mandate. It launched on 24 Feb 2025 as "a limited research preview", bundled with the Claude 3.7 Sonnet announcement, and reached general availability in May 2025.

WHY IT WORKED

Internal use gave the launch a believable story and a fast feedback loop. "Research preview" lowered expectations and made rough edges read as iteration. Riding a model launch borrowed its news cycle.

EVIDENCE

About 70 to 80% of technical staff used it daily during development, with "a post every five minutes" in the feedback channel [company-reported](#). Over \$500M run-rate revenue and usage up more than 10x in the three months after GA [company-reported, Sep 2025](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

October already has the product in use inside Capillary. Measure it from now (share of engineers using it weekly, feedback-channel volume) and publish the number at launch. If launch ends up as the outer loop only, call the rest a preview.

SOURCES

[Anthropic, 24 Feb 2025](#); [Anthropic Series F, 2 Sep 2025](#); [Every podcast, 29 Oct 2025](#)

12. Vercel: v0's waitlist opened on a fixed date with pricing already set (2023)

THE MOVE

Vercel announced v0, which generates UI components from a prompt, in October 2023 with a waitlist and access in waves. On 18 Dec 2023 it removed the waitlist and opened to everyone with a free tier (200 credits a month) and a \$20 paid tier. The output was standard React, Tailwind and shadcn code.

WHY IT WORKED

The waitlist turned demand into a number Vercel could announce. Opening with pricing already published turned that demand straight into paying users.

EVIDENCE

More than 100,000 signups in three weeks [third-party, DevClass and SD Times](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Open a design-partner waitlist with the 31 Oct website, qualified by organisation type and team size. Announce the count before launch, and open it on 19 Jan with pricing published. Don't open without pricing.

SOURCES

[DevClass, 10 Oct 2023](#); [SD Times, 18 Dec 2023](#)

3. Open source as distribution

13. HashiCorp: open-source downloads as the target-account list (2014 to 2021)

THE MOVE

Terraform, Vault, Consul and the rest shipped as open source under MPL 2.0. Enterprise and cloud versions were sold by a sales team that targeted large organisations whose engineers already used the free tools. HashiConf and local user groups sat on top.

WHY IT WORKED

Downloads were a free list of target accounts. Sales expanded existing use instead of cold-calling.

EVIDENCE

About 100M downloads in fiscal 2021, used by about 79% of the Fortune 500, 2,101 customers with 558 over \$100K, 124% net dollar retention, 36,000+ user-group members in 140+ chapters [company-reported, S-1 via Meritech](#). The caution: in August 2023 HashiCorp moved to the Business Source License, and within weeks rivals forked Terraform as OpenTofu under the Linux Foundation [third-party](#).

COST

\$349.5M raised to reach about \$300M ARR [third-party, Meritech](#). The licence change cost goodwill and created a competing fork.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Open-source one narrow piece (the spec format, a review-rules engine or a runbook runner) and have GrowthSpree prioritise accounts whose engineers star or download it. Pick the licence once, at launch, so there is never a relicensing moment.

SOURCES

[HashiCorp S-1, Nov 2021](#); [Meritech, 9 Nov 2021](#); [HashiCorp BSL post, 10 Aug 2023](#)

14. Sentry: wrote a licence, named "Fair Source", and started the Open Source Pledge (2023 to 2024)

THE MOVE

In November 2023 Sentry wrote the Functional Source License: code anyone can read and use except competitors, converting to Apache 2.0 or MIT after two years. In August 2024 it named the category "Fair Source", launched fair.io and signed five other companies. In October 2024 it launched the Open Source Pledge, where members pay maintainers at least \$2,000 per engineer a year and publish a report.

WHY IT WORKED

A licence restriction normally draws backlash. Sentry turned it into a named position others could join, and the Pledge made it the convener of a cause.

EVIDENCE

100,000 cloud customers and \$100M annual revenue at the Fair Source announcement [company-reported](#). The Pledge site shows \$7.4M paid to maintainers in total; members include Zerodha [company-reported](#).

COST

Sentry's own pledge is a \$270,000 a year minimum, and it employs a head of open source [company-reported](#).

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

If any part ships source-available, use FSL; don't invent a licence. Joining the Pledge in launch week is cheap and checkable, and Zerodha gives an Indian peer to name.

SOURCES

[Sentry, FSL, 17 Nov 2023](#); [Sentry is now Fair Source, 6 Aug 2024](#); [Open Source Pledge](#)

15. Grafana: "big tent", connecting to every data source including competitors' (2022)

THE MOVE

Grafana treats every data store as first-class, including Elasticsearch and Splunk, through 100+ plugins. The CEO made "embracing the big tent" the stated plan in the April 2022 Series D release, and Grafana named a podcast after it.

WHY IT WORKED

Ops teams rarely keep everything in one backend. Grafana became the one screen a team keeps whatever sits underneath, and its paid products were then sold into that screen.

EVIDENCE

Users configure 16 data sources on average, 24 at companies over 5,000 staff company-reported. Over \$400M ARR and 7,000+ customers by September 2025 company-reported.

COST

Not documented. Maintaining 100+ plugins takes a permanent team inferred.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Make "works with the stack you already have" a core message: Jira, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket, PagerDuty, Opsgenie and the customer's choice of model. Publish the integration count and track integrations per account. This also helps the "one screen" story.

SOURCES

Grafana, big tent, Jun 2025; Grafana \$400M ARR, 30 Sep 2025; BigDATAwire, 7 Apr 2022

16. n8n: self-hosting plus a template library written by users (2022 to 2025)

THE MOVE

n8n's code is public and anyone can self-host for internal use, but reselling it as a hosted service is barred (its Sustainable Use License, March 2022). Users publish workflows to a public template library, and each template is its own searchable page.

WHY IT WORKED

Self-hosting removed the security objection. When agents arrived, users filled the library with agent workflows, so n8n appeared wherever people searched "how do I build an agent that does X".

EVIDENCE

112,000+ GitHub stars added in 2025, first in JavaScript Rising Stars third-party. 6x users and 10x revenue in 2025 company-reported, via Highland Europe. About \$40M ARR and a \$2.5B valuation at the October 2025 Series C third-party. Over 10,000 community templates third-party.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Launch with a public library of user-contributed recipes (spec templates, review rule packs, on-call runbooks), each on its own indexable page with the author credited. Lead with VPC or air-gapped deployment for GCC security teams.

SOURCES

n8n licence post, 17 Mar 2022; Highland Europe, 9 Oct 2025; Wikipedia, n8n

17. Temporal: an open-source engine plus a small customer-led conference (2020 to 2023)

THE MOVE

The authors of Uber's Cadence forked it as Temporal, MIT-licensed. They ran Replay, a small in-person developer conference in Seattle, where customers such as Netflix, Datadog and Yum! Brands presented their own implementations. Revenue comes from Temporal Cloud.

WHY IT WORKED

Customer engineers' talks became reference stories that cost Temporal nothing and that buyers trust more than vendor material.

EVIDENCE

Community growing 10 to 15% a month; the first Replay drew 300+ in person company-reported. 50,000+ new developers in 2022, and Cloud customers and revenue up 20x in the year after the Series B third-party, SD Times.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

In the April to March plan, budget one 200 to 300 person event in Bengaluru where most talks are customer engineering teams showing their own agent pipelines.

SOURCES

Temporal, 28 Feb 2023; [SD Times](#), Feb 2023

18. GitLab: the public handbook and a free Remote Playbook (2020 to 2021)

THE MOVE

GitLab runs from a public handbook with a "handbook first" rule. In 2020 and again in April 2021 it packaged the remote-work parts into a free Remote Playbook, promoted by a dedicated Head of Remote.

WHY IT WORKED

A topic that wasn't the product ranked for high-volume searches at the moment every company needed the answer. The handbook also helped recruiting and trust.

EVIDENCE

Handbook at 10,400 pages in 2021 company-reported. About 420K monthly organic visits third-party estimate, AirOps. No playbook download numbers published.

COST

A full-time Head of Remote plus handbook-first discipline.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Publish an ungated "operating model for agent-assisted engineering" built from Capillary's own practice, aimed at GCC leaders being asked to write this policy now. Pairs with entry 6.

SOURCES

[GitLab press release](#), 20 Apr 2021; [The Lean Startup](#), 10 Jul 2025

4. Content and voice

19. Stripe: Increment magazine (2017 to 2021)

THE MOVE

A quarterly print and digital magazine on how teams build and run software at scale, one theme per issue. The first issue was on-call and incident response. Across 19 issues it barely mentioned Stripe. It closed in November 2021; Stripe Press, a book imprint, started in 2018.

WHY IT WORKED

It made Stripe the company that takes engineering seriously, in front of the senior engineers who choose infrastructure. Outside authors brought their audiences, and print copies stayed on desks.

EVIDENCE

19 issues, 250+ stories, 400+ contributors company-reported. No readership or lead numbers were ever published; effect on sales is inferred.

COST

A small in-house editorial team (Will Larson names three) plus print production.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

A themed quarterly on engineering with agents, mostly written by GCC and US platform leaders, first issue on on-call. Start digital-only; print a short run for the round tables and top accounts. More realistic for the April to March plan than this leg.

SOURCES

[Increment, About](#); [Will Larson, 13 Apr 2017](#)

20. PostHog: "Product for Engineers", a newsletter about the craft (2023 to 2025)

THE MOVE

A free Substack newsletter on product thinking for engineers, written in-house, with no product pitch. PostHog's handbook calls content the "main pillar" and says it does no PR and no big coordinated campaigns.

WHY IT WORKED

Writing about the job built an audience of the people who later choose tools. Substack recommendations spread it beyond PostHog's own reach.

EVIDENCE

About 38,000 subscribers at the start of 2025 and over 100,000 by the end; posts read over 1M times in 2025 company-reported.

COST

Not documented; one named in-house writer.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Start a weekly newsletter for engineering managers and GCC delivery heads on running teams with agents, by November, so the 19 Jan launch reaches a list you already own.

SOURCES

[PostHog, best of 2025, 22 Dec 2025](#); [PostHog marketing handbook](#)

21. Linear: "The Linear Method" (undated)

THE MOVE

A standalone set of principles in two parts, Direction (goals, prioritisation, scoping) and Building (momentum, writing issues, launching). The product is built to match the method.

WHY IT WORKED

It sells a way of working before the tool. Teams that agree with the method find the product's choices obvious and carry both to their next job.

EVIDENCE

Over \$100M ARR, 40,000+ paying customers and 177% net retention third-party, Pulse 2.0, Aug 2026. No metrics for the Method page itself.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Publish a method page before launch: named principles for building software when agents do much of the work, with "the loop closes at Spec" as the first. Write it so a GCC head can paste it into an internal policy.

SOURCES

Linear Method; Pulse 2.0, 28 Aug 2026

22. Fly.io: long Hacker News posts, failures included (2020 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Fly.io has no conventional marketing and no sales team, so its blog is the outreach. Posts run over 2,000 words with runnable code, written to stand up "even if an unrelated company posted it". When the platform was unreliable, it said so in public.

WHY IT WORKED

Dense engineering writing reached developers where they already read, at almost no media cost. The candid failure post outperformed the launch posts.

EVIDENCE

"Reliability: It's not great" scored 1,226 Hacker News points in March 2023, Fly.io's top post that year; its funding post scored 643 third-party, Plushcap.

COST

Senior engineers' writing time and a slow editing queue company-reported.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Have the engineers who built the agents publish one long post a month with real traces, such as "what our review agent got wrong in 1,000 PRs". When something breaks, write the candid version first.

SOURCES

Fly.io, A Blog, If You Can Keep It, 15 Feb 2025; Plushcap, Fly.io HN 2023

23. Honeycomb: the founder named the category, then gave away an O'Reilly book (2016 to 2026)

THE MOVE

Charity Majors, co-founder and CTO, took the control-theory term "observability" in 2016 and argued for it constantly on her blog and in talks. She co-wrote O'Reilly's *Observability Engineering* (May 2022), which Honeycomb gives away behind a form; a second edition came in 2026.

WHY IT WORKED

An opinionated founder plus a neutral-looking book from a respected publisher made Honeycomb's definition the industry's. The book then turned authority into leads.

EVIDENCE

Majors is "widely credited for coining the term observability" in this sense [third-party, TechTarget](#). Gartner now runs a Magic Quadrant for Observability Platforms [third-party](#). No download numbers.

COST

Several senior authors' time.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Pick the one phrase you want the market to use (agentic SDLC, or the term Gartner's "agent harness engineering" inquiry surfaced) and have one named executive argue for it weekly. A short O'Reilly-style report on it becomes the gated asset for GrowthSpree's ABM.

SOURCES

Honeycomb, 10 May 2022; TechTarget, Mar 2025

24. Basecamp: Shape Up, with a paid workshop as the prototype for a free book (2019)

THE MOVE

Before writing the book, Ryan Singer ran a \$1,000-a-seat workshop as a "prototyping device": it forced a day of content, gave instant feedback and tested demand. He then interviewed attendees. Shape Up launched in August 2019 as a free web book and PDF with no email gate; print followed after readers asked.

WHY IT WORKED

"Shaping", writing a bounded spec before building, gave teams a vocabulary that pointed back to Basecamp. The workshop tested the content on buyers before publication, and no gate meant it spread freely inside companies.

EVIDENCE

Singer called the traffic "incredible" and said a Fortune 50 company adopted the method [company-reported](#). No readership numbers.

COST

About a year of a senior product lead's part-time effort. The workshop earned money.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

This is the closest analogue to the Spec module. Run two or three paid or invite-only "spec with agents" workshops for GCC leaders in November and December, and publish the result on launch day as a free, ungated method book on writing specs agents can execute.

SOURCES

Ryan Singer, How I wrote Shape Up, 22 Aug 2019; 37signals podcast, Nov 2020

25. Sourcegraph: a named engineer's thesis essay ahead of the product (2023)

THE MOVE

Steve Yegge published "Cheating is All You Need" on Sourcegraph's blog in March 2023: a long, informal essay arguing that LLMs are a platform shift and that whoever fills the context window best wins, which is Sourcegraph's advantage. It became a series, with Cody's product posts following.

WHY IT WORKED

The essay sold the reason for the product before the product. A known engineer with a strong argument reaches engineers who skip launch posts.

EVIDENCE

The essay got 405 Hacker News points and 354 comments; the Cody product post got 201 and "Open Sourcing Cody" 105 third-party, Plushcap.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

In early December, before the dead weeks, publish a long, opinionated essay from a named engineering leader on why the loop closes at Spec. The 19 Jan product post is then the follow-up. The competitor guide covers Sourcegraph's later benchmark (entry 06).

SOURCES

[Sourcegraph](#), 23 Mar 2023; [Plushcap](#), [Sourcegraph HN](#) 2023

26. Sentry: bought the podcast it sponsored and removed the ads (2023)

THE MOVE

Sentry had sponsored the Syntax podcast for about 52 episodes a year. It bought the show, announced on episode 600 in April 2023, dropped all third-party ads, and funded a producer, a video creator and a marketing manager, with editorial left to the hosts.

WHY IT WORKED

Sponsorship rents attention one spot at a time. Ownership gave Sentry the whole show and its back catalogue, while editorial independence kept the trust.

EVIDENCE

About 52 sponsored episodes a year before the deal, 600 episodes by the announcement company-reported. Price and audience not disclosed.

COST

Undisclosed price plus at least three roles.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Not for this leg. For April onward, sponsor one Indian engineering podcast or YouTube channel that GCC leaders watch for a full year, from the influencer line.

SOURCES

[Sentry](#), 12 Apr 2023; [Syntax ep. 892](#), 9 Apr 2025

5. Developer events and community

27. dbt Labs: Slack first, conference second, and a named job title (2016 to 2022)

THE MOVE

dbt ran a public Slack for analytics engineers as its main support channel from early on. User-run city meetups came next. In March 2019 Claire Carroll's post "What is analytics engineering?" named a role whose work was exactly what dbt does. When the Coalesce conference launched, each of its 100+ sessions got its own Slack channel.

WHY IT WORKED

The community did support and word of mouth before there was a sales team, so the conference never had to recruit an audience. The job title created budget and postings, and everyone hired into it arrived trained on dbt.

EVIDENCE

Slack grew from 350 to 2,100 members between years two and three [company-reported, Jul 2019](#). Coalesce 2021 drew 7,000+ practitioners from 2,300+ companies [company-reported](#). Analytics-engineer posts in dbt's #jobs channel went from 6% in 2019 to 32% in 2022 [third-party, Metabase](#).

COST

Not documented. Founders did early support in Slack.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Open one practitioner channel before 19 Jan and invite round-table attendees as founding members, one channel per round-table topic. Separately, name the person who owns the spec-to-production agent pipeline and publish a free job description GCC HR teams can paste.

SOURCES

[dbt, Three years in, Jul 2019](#); [dbt, What is analytics engineering, 26 Mar 2019](#); [Metabase, 10 Aug 2022](#)

28. Humanitec: PlatformCon and platformengineering.org as a category play (2022 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Humanitec, an internal developer platform vendor, set up platformengineering.org and launched PlatformCon in 2022: free, virtual, a week of 15-minute practitioner talks chosen by open call for papers, with Humanitec as one sponsor among many. It grew local meetups (42 cities, including New Delhi) and added paid in-person days in London and New York.

WHY IT WORKED

It put its name on the category, not the product, so every buyer researching "platform engineering" met a community the vendor ran. When Gartner named platform engineering a top trend for 2024, the definitions and speakers already ran through Humanitec.

EVIDENCE

Attendance went from 6,000 (2022) to 16,000+ (2023); submissions 105 to 514; Slack 4,000 to 14,000 [company-reported](#). 35,000+ viewers in event week 2024 [company-reported](#). Gartner Top 10 trend, 16 Oct 2023 [third-party](#). New Delhi meetup: 2,260 members [third-party, Meetup](#).

COST

Not documented; 27 sponsors likely offset part of it [inferred](#).

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

PlatformCon is already on the calendar for 24 to 25 Feb. Submit a 15-minute talk co-presented with a design partner; a booth alone won't do it. The 2025 in-person days found were London and New York, so confirm the SF format. The competitor guide also profiles Humanitec.

SOURCES

[Humanitec, PlatformCon 2023, 20 Jul 2023](#); [Humanitec newsletter vol. 84, 16 Oct 2024](#); [Gartner, 16 Oct 2023](#); [Meetup, Platform Engineers New Delhi](#)

29. Vercel: personalised, shareable Next.js Conf tickets (2019 to 2022)

THE MOVE

Every registrant got a numbered ticket. Signing in with GitHub turned it into a personal image with avatar, name and handle at its own URL that previews well on social media. Vercel open-sourced the event site as the Virtual Event Starter Kit.

WHY IT WORKED

People post things about themselves, and a low ticket number was worth showing off. Each share was a free invitation to the registrant's followers.

EVIDENCE

Registrations went from 3,888 (2019) to 70,000+ (Oct 2021); 30,000 in one day in 2022 third-party, swyx. "Almost 40,000 live attendees" in 2020 company-reported.

COST

In-house design and engineering; not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Give every launch-livestream registrant a generated card using the open-loop mark and their GitHub or LinkedIn handle. For the round tables, use LinkedIn-ready seat cards.

SOURCES

swyx, Non Fungible Tickets, Sep 2022; [Vercel virtual-event-starter-kit](#)

30. swyx and AI Engineer: an essay names the role, an application-only conference sells it (2023 to 2026)

THE MOVE

In June 2023 swyx published "The Rise of the AI Engineer", naming a job that barely existed. Four months later a 500-seat summit in San Francisco ran by application only. The 2024 World's Fair added a "VP pass" for a closed-door leadership track. Gremlin did a smaller version in 2018: a one-day, single-track Chaos Conf in a cinema, which reportedly sold out its 350 tickets.

WHY IT WORKED

The essay defined who the event was for, so attending meant joining an identity. Admission by application made a seat a signal, and the livestream added reach without venue cost.

EVIDENCE

2023: about 400 accepted from 5,000+ applications, about 20,000 livestream viewers company-reported. 2024 World's Fair: 3,000+ attendees company-reported.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Make the Bengaluru and Hyderabad or Pune round tables application-only with a public seat cap, and hold a separate closed-door session for VPs alongside. Use a venue people remember, not a hotel ballroom.

SOURCES

AI Engineer, About; Latent Space, World's Fair 2024; Gremlin, Looking back on a day of chaos, 16 Oct 2018

31. MLOps Community: a neutral, sponsor-funded community (2020 to 2026)

THE MOVE

A weekly Zoom call and a Slack started in March 2020 grew into a podcast, newsletter, local chapters and virtual conferences, funded by many vendor sponsors and owned by none. In May 2026 it became the official user group of the Linux Foundation's Agentic AI Foundation.

WHY IT WORKED

A neutral host draws buyers who would never join one vendor's community, which gives sponsors an audience they couldn't build themselves.

EVIDENCE

31,000 Slack members, 600+ events in 45 cities, 7 virtual conferences with 50,000+ registrants

company-reported, May 2026 .

COST

Sponsor-funded.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

There's no time to build a community from zero by January. Offer practitioner talks on agentic review or on-call to existing neutral groups: MLOps Community chapters and the platformengineering.org meetups in Bengaluru and Delhi.

SOURCES

MLOps Community 2.0, 13 May 2026

6. Pricing and packaging as marketing

32. GitHub: Copilot free for students and maintainers, then Copilot Free (2022, 2024)

THE MOVE

At general availability in June 2022 Copilot cost \$10 a month and was free for verified students and maintainers of popular open-source projects, rechecked monthly. In December 2024 GitHub launched Copilot Free: 2,000 completions and 50 chat messages a month for anyone.

WHY IT WORKED

Free seats went to the people who shape what others use and to future hires. The capped free tier removed the credit card, and the caps pushed heavy users to pay.

EVIDENCE

1.2M developers in the technical preview company-reported. Over 15M users by May 2025 and 20M by August 2025 third-party.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Give free seats to maintainers of open-source projects GCC platform teams depend on and to student cohorts at colleges that feed GCC hiring. Meter the free tier by runs so the upgrade conversation starts itself.

SOURCES

GitHub, 21 Jun 2022; GitHub, Copilot Free, 18 Dec 2024; iTWire, 1 May 2025

33. Cursor: a \$20 plan engineers can expense, as the way into enterprise (2023 to 2026)

THE MOVE

Cursor sold mainly to individuals at \$20 a month and let engineers expense it before any company deal existed. Once usage spread inside companies it added team and enterprise plans with admin, analytics and SSO. In July 2025 it changed Pro to usage-metered caps, drew complaints, reversed and refunded.

WHY IT WORKED

A price that fits an expense report spread usage without procurement. The enterprise deal formalised use that already existed.

EVIDENCE

ARR \$100M (Jan 2025), \$500M (Jun 2025), over \$1B (Nov 2025), \$3B (May 2026)

third-party, via Wikipedia citing TechCrunch and Bloomberg.

COST

Not documented. The pricing reversal cost goodwill.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Have a self-serve plan an engineer can expense on 19 Jan, even though enterprise is the target, and give the account team a "who in your organisation already uses us" report as the opening move. Don't change individual terms after launch without notice.

SOURCES

Wikipedia, Anysphere; eWeek, 2025

34. Tailscale: a free plan rebuilt around the step from one user to two (2023)

THE MOVE

Tailscale's Pricing v3 raised the free plan from one user to three, gave paid plans three free users, and billed monthly only for users who actually exchanged data. The CEO explained it with growth data.

WHY IT WORKED

The data showed single-user networks spread faster than they were lost (R0 above 1), and multi-user networks did not (R0 below 1). The friction was convincing the second person, so Tailscale made small teams free.

EVIDENCE

The R0 finding [company-reported, Apr 2023](#). At its 2025 Series C, business customers were up 20% since January and revenue growth was over 100% a year [company-reported, via Pulse 2.0](#).

COST

Small-team revenue given up.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Find the step from one engineer to a team (the second reviewer, the second person on the on-call rota) and make it free. A three-person team running spec, review and on-call before procurement is involved is the GCC version.

SOURCES

Tailscale, Pricing v3, 18 Apr 2023; Pulse 2.0, 2025

35. CodeRabbit: free AI review on every public repo, plus a \$10M pledge (2023 to 2026)

THE MOVE

CodeRabbit reviews pull requests on any public GitHub or GitLab repo free, with no application. It pledged \$10M to open source, paid as maintainer cash and covered usage, with a live counter of reviewed PRs.

WHY IT WORKED

Every public review is a demo in front of contributors who work at paying companies. The pledge turned the free tier's cost into a public story.

EVIDENCE

About 1.7M open-source PRs reviewed, \$1.2M+ cash and \$6.1M+ covered usage since February 2025

[company-reported](#). \$15M ARR and 8,000 customers in September 2025 [third-party](#). Its site cites a Swiggy case study [company-reported](#).

COST

\$7.3M+ so far against the \$10M pledge [company-reported](#).

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

The closest analogue to the Review module. Free review and spec-from-issue on public repos that GCCs depend on, with a running counter from launch day. The reserve's subsidised-harness experiment could fund a capped version. Expect CodeRabbit to be the comparison in Indian accounts; the competitor guide profiles it.

SOURCES

CodeRabbit OSS; CodeRabbit open source; ARR.club, 19 Sep 2025

36. Neon: a free tier built for other companies' agents (2024 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Neon's serverless Postgres starts in about 500 ms with instant branching, and it integrated with Vercel, Replit and others so their agents could create databases automatically. The free plan grew to 100 projects so an agent making throwaway databases wasn't blocked.

WHY IT WORKED

Other companies' agents became the free tier's users. Every agent session created a Neon database without a human choosing it.

EVIDENCE

Over 80% of databases provisioned on Neon were created by AI agents, not people

[company-reported, Databricks and Neon, 14 May 2025](#). An earlier 30% figure that circulates could not be found in either source. Databricks bought Neon for about \$1B [third-party](#).

COST

Free-tier infrastructure; not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Make OneFlux callable by Claude Code, Copilot and Cursor through MCP on a free metered tier, so spec and review runs triggered by those tools count as usage. Report the agent-triggered share as a number to watch. The competitor guide's Augment entry (02) is the same idea.

SOURCES

[Databricks, 14 May 2025](#); [Neon, 14 May 2025](#)

7. Enterprise plays that kept developer credibility

37. Snyk: developers adopt free, the CISO buys governance (2015 to 2021)

THE MOVE

Snyk launched as a free Node.js scanner for open-source owners and small teams, with automatic fix pull requests and a GitHub badge maintainers displayed. In July 2016 it put up a developer paywall at about \$100 per developer a month. Conversion failed, so in 2017 it hired its first account executive and sold reporting, admin and policy to CISOs, with developer adoption as the evidence.

WHY IT WORKED

The user and the buyer were different people. Developer use proved the tool would be used, and governance gave the security budget a reason to pay.

EVIDENCE

About 5,000 registered developers by mid-2016; on the paywall, the founder said "We opened the floodgates and got a trickle" [company-reported](#). ARR went from \$100K (Aug 2017) to \$4M (2018), \$19M (2019) and \$326M (Feb 2026), though growth slowed to 7% a year [third-party, Sacra](#).

COST

A year of failed self-serve monetisation.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Treat free usage as evidence, not a funnel that converts by itself. Package usage (PRs reviewed, incidents triaged, specs closed) into a VP or CTO report, and price the governance layer: audit trail of agent actions, policy, reporting.

SOURCES

[Unusual Ventures](#), 12 Apr 2022; [Sacra](#), Snyk at \$326M ARR; [Boldstart](#), 9 Sep 2021

38. Palantir, then OpenAI: forward-deployed engineers as the sales motion (2025)

THE MOVE

Engineers embed with the customer and write code on the customer's systems to get the product into production, working alongside sales. Palantir invented the role; OpenAI built an FDE team in 2025, and a16z called the pattern "services-led growth".

WHY IT WORKED

Agent products fail between demo and production. FDEs close that gap, find product gaps early and embed the vendor in critical workflows.

EVIDENCE

OpenAI had 10+ FDEs across 8 cities in the first year [third-party, Pragmatic Engineer](#). Implementation-heavy predecessors started with low gross margins and recovered: ServiceNow 63% at IPO to 79% by 2024 [third-party, a16z](#).

COST

Lower early gross margin, and engineers pulled from core product.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Offer a fixed six-week FDE pod to the first ABM accounts, run from India so the cost works for both GCC and US accounts. Turn each engagement into a published playbook so it doesn't become consulting. The Indigo onboarding lessons are the first draft.

SOURCES

[a16z](#), [Trading Margin for Moat](#), 4 Jun 2025; [Pragmatic Engineer](#), 12 Aug 2025

39. GitLab and AWS: launching off the first Gartner Magic Quadrant for AI Code Assistants (2024)

THE MOVE

Gartner's first Magic Quadrant for AI Code Assistants (August 2024) evaluated 12 vendors. GitLab and AWS each announced Leader placement within days; GitLab offered the full report to prospects with a free-trial sign-up attached.

WHY IT WORKED

The first edition of a Magic Quadrant fixes who counts as a vendor in the category, and procurement uses it as a shortlist.

EVIDENCE

12 vendors, GitLab and AWS Leaders company-reported.

COST

Reprint licences; amount not public.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

The Gartner relationship is already paid for. Ask the analysts which evaluations an agentic SDLC platform could qualify for, with inclusion criteria and dates. If an MQ is out of reach before launch, aim for a Cool Vendor or Hype Cycle sample-vendor mention, as Humanitec got in 2022.

SOURCES

[GitLab](#), 22 Aug 2024; [AWS](#), Aug 2024

40. Jellyfish: a vendor-owned annual survey for engineering leaders (2020 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Jellyfish, an engineering-metrics vendor, publishes an annual State of Engineering Management report behind a form. The 2025 edition's headline gap, that few teams measure AI's impact, is exactly what Jellyfish sells.

WHY IT WORKED

One survey gives a quotable statistic each year, collects leads, and states the problem the product solves.

EVIDENCE

Sixth edition, 600+ respondents; 90% of teams (up from 61% a year earlier) use AI coding tools but only 20% measure impact with engineering metrics company-reported.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

The Research NXT survey and report already sit in the plan. Design its questions so the headline gap is the one OneFlux closes (for example, "agents write code but nobody owns review or on-call"), with an India GCC and US split, and publish it in launch week or at the first round table. The competitor guide's DX entry (07) covers the credibility side.

SOURCES

[Jellyfish](#), 8 Jul 2025

41. Puppet, DORA and Google: owning the yardstick (2013 to 2024)

THE MOVE

Puppet sponsored the State of DevOps report from 2013 with Gene Kim, Jez Humble and Nicole Forsgren. The research team spun out as DORA, published *Accelerate* in 2018, and Google Cloud acquired DORA in December 2018. Its "four key metrics" became the standard measure of delivery performance. In 2024 the report published findings that were bad news for AI tools.

WHY IT WORKED

Whoever owns the metrics shapes what buyers ask every vendor. Google bought a buying-criteria framework, not a product, and publishing unwelcome AI findings protected its credibility.

EVIDENCE

2024 report: a 25% rise in AI adoption is associated with +7.5% documentation quality, +3.1% review speed, but -1.5% delivery throughput and -7.2% delivery stability company-reported, Google. Nine paying gold sponsors on the 2024 report company-reported.

COST

Acquisition price undisclosed.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Map OneFlux's measures onto DORA's four keys, so analysts and buyers can check them against a yardstick they trust. DORA's stability finding is a ready-made opening for the Review and On-call story.

SOURCES

[DORA joins Google Cloud, 20 Dec 2018](#); [Google Cloud, 2024 DORA report, 23 Oct 2024](#)

8. Proof, benchmarks and public failure

42. GitHub: a randomised trial as Copilot's launch number (2022, 2024)

THE MOVE

GitHub and Microsoft economists randomly split 95 professional developers and timed them writing an HTTP server in JavaScript, with and without Copilot. GitHub published the effect size, p-value and confidence interval. In 2024 it ran a randomised trial inside Accenture and published enterprise measures.

WHY IT WORKED

"55% faster" became the number buyers and press repeated for years, and showing the statistics made it read as research. The Accenture study moved the claim to a named enterprise, which is what a VP Engineering needs for a budget case.

EVIDENCE

1h11m against 2h41m, $p=.0017$, 95% CI 21% to 89% [company-reported](#). Accenture: +8.69% pull requests, +15% merge rate, +84% successful builds [company-reported](#). Counter-evidence: METR's 2025 trial found experienced developers 19% slower with AI while believing they were 20% faster [third-party](#).

COST

Research team time and paid participants.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Run one small randomised study with a November design partner, ideally a GCC, and publish the method and interval, not only the headline. Measure past code written (review time, time to fix an incident), because METR is the sceptic's script.

SOURCES

[GitHub](#), 7 Sep 2022; [GitHub and Accenture](#), 13 May 2024; [METR](#), 10 Jul 2025

43. Augment Code: #1 on SWE-bench Verified, with the benchmark's limits in the same post (2025)

THE MOVE

Augment published 65.4% on SWE-bench Verified, the top open-source agent at the time, and open-sourced the pipeline. In the same post it said scores are "largely driven by the quality of the foundation model" and listed what the benchmark misses: Python only, small codebases, bug fixes not features.

WHY IT WORKED

It took the leaderboard headline and showed sceptical engineers it understood the benchmark, which supported its real pitch on large-codebase context.

EVIDENCE

65.4% [company-reported](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

When publishing any score, put "what this doesn't measure" in the same post, then show your own evaluation on an enterprise-sized, multi-language repo. The competitor guide covers Augment's other moves.

SOURCES

[Augment Code](#), 31 Mar 2025; [OpenAI, SWE-bench Verified](#), 13 Aug 2024

44. Greptile: a benchmark that names every competitor (2025)

THE MOVE

Greptile tested five AI review tools on 50 real bugs from five open-source repos (Sentry, Cal.com, Grafana, Keycloak, Discourse), default settings, counting a bug as caught only with a line-level comment explaining the impact. It named every competitor and score.

WHY IT WORKED

Most enterprise vendors avoid naming rivals. Using public, checkable PRs made the result hard to dismiss and gave buyers a ready comparison table on Greptile's terms.

EVIDENCE

Greptile 82%, Cursor Bugbot 58%, Copilot 54%, CodeRabbit 44%, Graphite 6% company-reported, Jul 2025. It doesn't say who ran the evaluation inferred.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Publish a reproducible benchmark where none exists yet, such as incident triage accuracy using public postmortems as ground truth, and disclose who ran it. The competitor guide covers Greptile's self-review study (entry 09).

SOURCES

[Greptile benchmarks, Jul 2025](#)

45. Bun: a 1.0 post built as a wall of head-to-head benchmarks (2023)

THE MOVE

The Bun 1.0 post on 8 Sep 2023 compared Bun against the named tool it replaced in each job: runtime, test runner, bundler, package manager. Each claim was a specific multiple. Cloudflare did a version in 2018, publishing p95 latency tests of Workers against AWS Lambda with the methodology and a third-party measurement tool.

WHY IT WORKED

Each claim was concrete and checkable against a tool developers already used, and one post covered four categories.

EVIDENCE

Tests 13x faster than Jest, bundling 220x faster than webpack, among others company-reported. A Node.js core contributor confirmed the install speed but disputed "drop-in replacement" third-party.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

For each module, publish one comparison against what the buyer uses today, measured in time or cycles. Don't overclaim compatibility; Bun's backlash was about "drop-in", not speed.

SOURCES

[Bun 1.0, 8 Sep 2023](#); [Matteo Collina, 11 Sep 2023](#); [Cloudflare, 2 Jul 2018](#)

46. GitLab: livestreamed its own database-loss recovery (2017)

THE MOVE

On 31 Jan 2017 an engineer deleted GitLab.com's production database and five backup methods failed. GitLab made its recovery notes a public Google Doc, livestreamed the recovery call on YouTube, and published a full postmortem on 10 February. Livestreaming severe incidents then went into its runbooks.

WHY IT WORKED

Developers watched engineers work the problem, so it read as a shared on-call story. Nobody could call it a cover-up.

EVIDENCE

About 5,000 concurrent viewers, YouTube's #2 live stream for hours [company-reported](#) . About 5,000 projects, 5,000 comments and 700 accounts lost over about 18 hours [company-reported](#) .

COST

The outage and lost data. No marketing spend.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Decide now that when the on-call agent works a real incident, yours or a design partner's, you will publish its timeline and reasoning as the postmortem, including what it got wrong.

SOURCES

[GitLab postmortem, 10 Feb 2017](#); [Increment, Apr 2017](#)

47. Cloudflare: same-day, code-level post-mortems (2019 to 2025)

THE MOVE

After major outages, Cloudflare's CEO or CTO publishes a detailed post-mortem with code, error messages and timeline, often the same day. For the 18 Nov 2025 outage, the post showed the Rust panic and how a doubled feature file broke a 200-feature limit.

WHY IT WORKED

For infrastructure buyers, a fast, specific explanation proves the vendor understands its own system. Press covered the transparency, not only the outage.

EVIDENCE

About 5.5 hours of significant impact, post published the same day [company-reported](#) . Infosecurity Magazine cited it as how trust is earned [third-party](#) . No figure links post-mortems to retention.

COST

Senior executive time on the worst day.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Commit publicly to a post-mortem within 24 hours of any customer-visible failure, written with the help of your own On-call module. Each one doubles as a demo.

SOURCES

[Cloudflare, 18 Nov 2025](#); [Infosecurity Magazine, 23 Jul 2019](#)

9. Marketplaces and partner channels

48. CrowdStrike and Datadog: billing against the cloud spend the buyer already committed (2018 to 2024)

THE MOVE

CrowdStrike listed Falcon on AWS Marketplace in 2018 and moved enterprise deals onto private offers, so customers buy through their AWS account and the cost counts against their AWS commitment. Resellers and SIs were brought onto the same route so the channel kept its margin. Datadog went further on Azure: it became a native Azure resource, created in the Azure portal like a VM, with Entra ID sign-on and usage billed on the Azure invoice against the customer's Microsoft consumption commitment.

WHY IT WORKED

Money already committed to a cloud provider needs no new budget line or new vendor approval. Keeping partners on the deal meant the channel pushed the marketplace route.

EVIDENCE

CrowdStrike sold \$1B+ through AWS Marketplace in calendar 2024 alone, and says marketplace deals average 4x larger [\[company-reported\]](#). 48% of buyers in Tackle's survey say drawing down committed spend is their top reason to buy through a marketplace [\[third-party\]](#). AWS Marketplace opened INR invoicing and India-based sellers on 6 Nov 2025, naming TCS and Swiggy as buyers [\[company-reported\]](#). Datadog's Azure integration counts toward the Azure commitment [\[company-reported, Microsoft Learn\]](#); no adoption figures published.

COST

Listing fees and a partner-alliances hire [\[unverified\]](#); Datadog's was joint engineering with Microsoft.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Be transactable on AWS Marketplace on 19 Jan with a private-offer template, so a US parent's committed spend can fund a GCC pilot, and list INR private offers for India buyers. Put Azure Marketplace eligibility on the April to March plan for GCCs on Microsoft agreements.

SOURCES

[ChannelLife](#), 27 Feb 2025; [CrowdStrike via BusinessWire](#), 26 Feb 2025; [Tackle](#), 20 Jul 2023; [Amazon](#), [AWS Marketplace in India](#), 6 Nov 2025; [Datadog](#), [Azure partnership, 2020 to 2021](#); [Microsoft Learn](#), [Datadog on Azure](#)

49. Atlassian Marketplace: the app that lives where the tickets are (2012 to 2024)

THE MOVE

Third parties sell apps billed alongside Jira and Confluence licences and installed by the customer's Jira admins. Atlassian also sells through 700+ Solution Partners, consultancies that implement Jira for enterprises and recommend apps while they do.

WHY IT WORKED

Apps arrive on the existing Atlassian bill, so procurement sees no new vendor. Customers with two or more apps stay longer, so Atlassian promotes them.

EVIDENCE

\$4B in lifetime Marketplace sales by January 2024; the first billion took about eight years and the fourth just over one [company-reported](#). 1,800+ vendors, 5,700+ apps, about 20,000 installs a week [company-reported, Apr 2024](#). Over 70% of Jira and Confluence Cloud customers had at least one app in 2021 [company-reported](#).

COST

Atlassian's revenue share; vendor costs not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Specs at most GCCs start as Jira epics and Confluence pages. A Forge app that turns an epic into a OneFlux spec puts the Spec module inside the tool procurement already approved, and gives Atlassian Solution Partners something to recommend.

SOURCES

[Atlassian, 26 Apr 2024](#); [Atlassian, 9 Dec 2021](#)

50. Infosys and Cognizant: the systems integrator as customer zero and channel (2024 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Infosys rolled GitHub Copilot out to its own engineers, published the usage, then opened a GitHub Center of Excellence to sell Copilot and GitHub migrations to clients; GitHub named it Channel Partner of the Year 2025. Cognizant agreed to deploy Claude, including Claude Code, to up to 350,000 employees and to offer it to clients through workshops and reference patterns. Cognizant also ran a 10-day internal vibe-coding hackathon with Lovable, Windsurf, Cursor, Gemini Code Assist and Copilot on its tool shelf.

WHY IT WORKED

An SI that already runs a tool at scale has proof and trained people on day one. Indian SIs staff a large share of engineering at GCCs and US enterprises, so their default stack spreads with each engagement.

EVIDENCE

18,000+ Infosys developers on Copilot and 7M+ lines of Copilot code by October 2024 [company-reported](#). Cognizant is one of Anthropic's three largest enterprise customers [third-party, Computerworld](#). The hackathon drew 53,199 active participants in 40 countries and holds a Guinness record [company-reported; third-party, Guinness](#).

COST

Deal values not disclosed.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Sign one Indian SI (a large one, or a mid-tier such as Sonata) as customer zero before 19 Jan: OneFlux on its delivery teams at a partner rate, co-published usage numbers, and co-branded playbooks it sells into the GCCs it already staffs. If it runs an internal hackathon, ask for per-tool usage counts in advance.

SOURCES

[Infosys and Microsoft, 9 Oct 2024](#); [Anthropic, Cognizant partnership, 4 Nov 2025](#); [Computerworld, 5 Nov 2025](#); [Cognizant newsroom, 21 Aug 2025](#)

51. Upstash: Context7, a free MCP server that markets a database company (2025 to 2026)

THE MOVE

In April 2025 Upstash, a serverless data company, shipped Context7, a free MCP server that pulls current, version-pinned library docs into Cursor, Claude, VS Code and 30+ other clients when a user types "use context7". Library maintainers add their own docs. It spread through MCP directories and the "install these first" lists coding-agent users share.

WHY IT WORKED

It fixed a pain every AI-coding user has, outdated API suggestions, at no cost. Every install puts Upstash's name inside the agent.

EVIDENCE

62.7K GitHub stars and 3.1K forks third-party, GitHub, Oct 2026. GitHub launched its MCP Registry with one-click VS Code install on 16 Sep 2025 company-reported.

COST

Upstash team time; not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Release one free MCP server that does a single narrow job, such as feeding a team's architecture decisions or service catalogue into any coding agent, and list it in the GitHub MCP Registry before December. It reaches engineers months before the platform launch.

SOURCES

[Upstash, 11 Apr 2025](#); [upstash/context7](#); [GitHub MCP Registry, 16 Sep 2025](#)

10. Growth loops built into the product

52. Statuspage: a "Powered by Statuspage" footer on every customer's page (2013 to 2016, still live)

THE MOVE

Every hosted status page, including paying enterprise customers', carried a small "powered by" link. A YC partner suggested it; the co-founder first refused because it seemed disrespectful to paying customers, then tested it. It is still there: githubstatus.com shows "Powered by Atlassian Statuspage".

WHY IT WORKED

A status page gets its most traffic during an outage, when the customer's engineers and buyers are all looking, and those readers are other software companies, which were Statuspage's buyers.

EVIDENCE

The badge drove 30 to 40% of new customer acquisition, and fewer than 10 of about 1,500 paying accounts asked to remove it [company-reported, founder in a podcast interview, not audited](#). Atlassian acquired Statuspage in July 2016

[third-party, TechCrunch](#) .

COST

Close to zero engineering. The risk of annoying customers didn't materialise.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Every incident summary and post-incident page the On-call agent writes carries "Drafted by OneFlux On-call". The readers are the GCC team's US stakeholders and other business units, which is the expansion audience. Keep it on by default with an admin switch.

SOURCES

[SaaS Podcast ep. 87, Scott Klein](#); [TechCrunch, 14 Jul 2016](#); githubstatus.com

53. Anthropic: Claude Code's default co-author trailer and PR footer (2025 to 2026)

THE MOVE

By default Claude Code adds "Co-Authored-By: Claude" to commits and "Generated with Claude Code" to pull requests, and GitHub shows Claude as a co-author. Users can switch it off. The precedent is bot PRs: after Mend made the Renovate dependency bot free in 2019, every Renovate PR carried its banner, and GitHub ran the same play with Dependabot.

WHY IT WORKED

The attribution sits in the permanent record of every repo the tool touches. Outsiders could count it, so third-party estimates of market share became marketing.

EVIDENCE

SemiAnalysis estimated Claude Code authors about 4% of public GitHub commits third-party, via Xataka, Feb 2026. Amplifying tracks a 91.6% merge rate across 4.6M+ attributed PRs, Jul to Sep 2026 third-party. Renovate had 1M+ PRs by November 2019; Dependabot passed 1M merged PRs by July 2019 company-reported. Counts are a floor, since users can turn attribution off inferred.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Ship a default "Co-authored-by: OneFlux" trailer and a PR footer linking to the spec the change came from, with an admin switch. Inside a large GCC's private repos it still spreads across teams, and in public repos it lets analysts count you.

SOURCES

[ClaudeLog, attribution setting](#); [Xataka, 6 Feb 2026](#); [Amplifying, Claude Code](#); [Mend, 13 Nov 2019](#); [GitHub, 25 Jul 2019](#)

54. Vercel and Netlify: preview links that bring non-developers into the product (2016, 2022)

THE MOVE

Every push to a pull request gets its own preview URL, posted on the PR by a bot; Netlify shipped Deploy Previews in August 2016. In September 2022 Vercel added Figma-style comments on the preview itself, with an "Add your feedback" link that logs visitors in, aimed at designers, product managers and QA.

WHY IT WORKED

The build's output, a link, travels to people who aren't developers and aren't users yet. Leaving a comment is the step that makes them sign in.

EVIDENCE

Companies ramp from an occasional thread to about 100 comments a day around launches company-reported, Vercel CTO via TechCrunch, Dec 2022. Netlify lists Deploy Previews as a milestone on its road to 1M developers company-reported.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Each generated spec or review gets a shareable link that US business stakeholders can open and comment on without a seat, with sign-in on comment. That turns the US enterprise's reviewers into OneFlux identities.

SOURCES

[Vercel, 22 Sep 2022](#); [TechCrunch, 20 Dec 2022](#); [Netlify milestones, 3 Aug 2020](#)

55. Postman, Netlify and StackBlitz: buttons and embeds in other people's docs (2016 to 2024)

THE MOVE

API publishers put a "Run in Postman" button in their docs that forks their collection into the developer's workspace, linked so updates flow through; in 2021 Postman grouped these into the Public API Network. Netlify's "Deploy to Netlify" button (November 2016) clones a template and deploys it in one click from any README. StackBlitz's in-browser runtime powers the official tutorials of SvelteKit, Angular and Nuxt.

WHY IT WORKED

Other companies place the button or embed because it cuts their own onboarding friction, so every developer evaluating their API or framework lands in the vendor's product.

EVIDENCE

Postman's network served 17M users and 500,000 organisations in August 2021 company-reported. An outside count found about 232,000 backlinks to Netlify's deploy flow, roughly half from GitHub third-party, Apr 2021. StackBlitz tutorials reach 500,000+ unique learners a month company-reported, Jul 2024.

COST

Small features; not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Publish forkable reference specs (an SAP or Salesforce integration, a payments service) with a "Fork into OneFlux" button and a visible fork count, and ask partner ISVs to embed it in their developer docs. Offer an embeddable sandbox to the onboarding academies GCCs run for new hires.

SOURCES

Postman, [Run in Postman](#); Help Net Security, [10 Aug 2021](#); Netlify, [29 Nov 2016](#); Scott Mathson, [9 Apr 2021](#); StackBlitz, [25 Jul 2024](#)

11. Education, certification and India developer programmes

56. Microsoft: AI Odyssey, a one-month credential sprint for Indian developers (2024)

THE MOVE

On 8 Jan 2024 Microsoft India opened a free programme that closed on 31 Jan. Level 1 was Azure AI learning modules; level 2 was a lab-based assessment that earned a Microsoft Applied Skills credential. Finishers could win a VIP pass to the Microsoft AI Tour in Bengaluru on 8 Feb, where Satya Nadella spoke.

WHY IT WORKED

A short window, a verifiable credential and a scarce in-person prize turned self-paced learning into a race. The finish line was Microsoft's own flagship event, so the learning funnel fed the room.

EVIDENCE

100,000 developers in India "enabled" in January 2024 [company-reported](#). Phase 2 across Asia targeted 150,000 more [company-reported, target](#). The Bengaluru AI Tour drew 1,100 developers and technology leaders [company-reported](#). GitHub's Octoverse projects India at 57.5M developers by 2030 against 54.7M in the US [third-party, The Register](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Run a four-week OneFlux sprint closing in launch week. Level 1 covers the spec-to-on-call loop; level 2 is a lab running an agent through all four modules on a sample repo. Finishers win seats at a Bengaluru launch session with GCC engineering leaders, so the people who earn the credential meet the people who buy.

SOURCES

[Microsoft India, 8 Jan 2024](#); [Microsoft India, Feb 2024](#); [The Register, 29 Oct 2025](#)

57. CNCF: Kubestronaut, a named title for holding all five certifications (2024 to 2026)

THE MOVE

At KubeCon Paris in April 2024 CNCF created the "Kubestronaut" title for anyone holding all five Kubernetes certifications. Holders get a jacket, a badge, a private Slack, 50% off five certifications a year and event discounts. A "Golden" tier for all CNCF certifications followed in 2025, and recertification in March 2026.

WHY IT WORKED

It turned five exams into one identity worth collecting, with a jacket people wear at events. The coupons push holders to buy more exams, and the country counts give India its own news story.

EVIDENCE

500+ Kubestronauts by August 2024 with India first; about 2,000 across 97 countries by August 2025 with India top at 180; 3,500+ by March 2026 [company-reported](#). In CNCF's survey 37% said the certifications helped them get a job [company-reported](#).

COST

Jackets and coupons; not otherwise documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Create one named title for engineers certified on all four modules, with a physical item and a public count by country. India GCC engineers will likely lead the table early, which is an India press story, and the "helped me get a job" line belongs in sales decks.

SOURCES

[CNCF, 27 Aug 2024](#); [CNCF, Aug 2025](#); [CNCF, 23 Mar 2026](#)

58. MongoDB: an India student pipeline through government channels (2023 to 2026)

THE MOVE

In September 2023 MongoDB launched an India academia programme targeting 500,000 students: free training, educator curriculum, Atlas credits, certifications and PhD fellowships. In 2024 it added AICTE, the national technical-education regulator, and a virtual-internship platform aligned to Skill India, plus a GeeksforGeeks learning path. In June 2026 it raised the target to 2 million builders by 2030, with curriculum in Kannada, Hindi and Tamil. Snowflake followed with a Nasscom FutureSkills Prime programme in March 2025.

WHY IT WORKED

Government channels open hundreds of colleges at once and carry credibility a vendor can't buy. Internships put Atlas into project work, and MongoDB ties the pipeline to its enterprise story: it says it serves half of India's top 100 companies.

EVIDENCE

650,000+ students trained by June 2026, past the original goal company-reported. 100,000+ students and 200+ institutions after year one company-reported. Snowflake aims to enrol 100,000 Indian learners in two years company-reported, target.

COST

Fellowships up to \$50,000 each; programme budget not documented. Snowflake's global programme is \$20M company-reported.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Nasscom's FutureSkills Prime is the closer door, because GCCs sit inside Nasscom. A free "agentic SDLC" course there, co-signed by a GCC talent head, can feed GCC fresher hiring. Start with the 10 to 20 colleges that supply the target GCCs.

SOURCES

MongoDB, 12 Sep 2023; MongoDB, 12 Sep 2024; MongoDB, 30 Jun 2026; The Week (PTI), 21 Mar 2025

59. WeMakeDevs: sponsored tracks in a creator-run hackathon (2023 to 2026)

THE MOVE

Kunal Kushwaha, an Indian creator and CNCF Ambassador, runs online hackathons through his WeMakeDevs community where each sponsor funds a track judged on "best use" of its technology. At FutureStack GenAI (Sep to Oct 2025) Cerebras, Meta, Docker and OpenRouter sponsored; the Cerebras and Meta tracks paid \$5,000 each plus an interview or a chat with their engineers.

WHY IT WORKED

The creator brings the audience and the trust. Judging on use of the sponsor's API makes signing up part of entering, and an interview is a cheap prize that early-career engineers value.

EVIDENCE

5,500+ participants and 7,000+ API signups for the Cerebras hackathon company-reported, by WeMakeDevs, not independently verified. Community of 200K+ members company-reported.

COST

About \$5,000 per sponsor track in prizes; sponsorship fees not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Sponsor one WeMakeDevs track in early December (before the dead weeks) that requires the On-call or Review agent, with an interview at a partner GCC as the prize. Issue API keys per participant so you can report signups per rupee. It fits the influencer line.

SOURCES

WeMakeDevs; FutureStack GenAI, 2025

60. Codeium (Windsurf): a free, vendor-taught DeepLearning.AI course (2025)

THE MOVE

In February 2025 DeepLearning.AI released "Build Apps with Windsurf's AI Coding Agents", a free course of about an hour taught by Codeium's head of enterprise and partnerships. It covers how agents use context and tools, updating a large legacy codebase, and building a full app.

WHY IT WORKED

The product reached a large audience under Andrew Ng's brand, framed as a skill. Ng says DeepLearning.AI has never taken payment to create a course, which makes it read as neutral.

EVIDENCE

DeepLearning.AI has 10M+ learners and 150+ courses company-reported. Enrolment for this course isn't published unverified.

COST

No fee either way, per Ng; the vendor supplies a senior instructor and content.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Pitch DeepLearning.AI a topic, not the product, such as spec-driven development with agents from spec to on-call, taught by OneFlux's lead engineer. It's selective, so pitch this autumn for a 2027 release.

SOURCES

DeepLearning.AI course; Andrew Ng, The Batch, 3 Jul 2026

61. Cursor: volunteer ambassadors, an India roadshow, then a rupee plan (2025 to 2026)

THE MOVE

Cursor funds volunteer Ambassadors to run local meetups, hackathons and "Cafe Cursor" days, covering costs and sending stickers. In India this built up to a roadshow in Hyderabad and Bangalore, teased as "launching something exclusive to India". On 28 Jul 2026 it launched Cursor Start, an India-only plan at ₹649 a month, payable by UPI.

WHY IT WORKED

Volunteer meetups built a local audience before the roadshow, so the rooms filled. The rupee price and UPI met a long-voiced demand.

EVIDENCE

800+ events in 250+ cities, 300+ Ambassadors company-reported. India users tripled in a year to 3M+ developers, Cursor's third-largest market company-reported. A Hyderabad meetup drew 205 attendees company-reported, Luma.

COST

Meetup funding and stickers; not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

This is the main India competitor's playbook, already running. Recruit 10 to 20 GCC engineers as named champions before 19 Jan and fund their meetups in Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune and Chennai. Reveal one India-specific offer on stage at the round tables, such as INR team billing or a GCC pilot package.

SOURCES

Cursor Ambassadors; Cursor, Cursor Start India, 28 Jul 2026; The Next Web, Jul 2026; Luma, Cursor India Roadshow Hyderabad

12. Field marketing and enterprise programmes

62. MongoDB and Snowflake: voucher-only events across three Indian cities in ten days (2022 to 2026)

THE MOVE

MongoDB.local Bengaluru is invite-only: registration needs a voucher code, and customers are told to ask their MongoDB rep, so the account team controls the guest list. In 2024 MongoDB ran Bangalore, Delhi NCR and Mumbai between 10 and 19 September, inside an 18-city world tour. Snowflake ran the same three-city India pattern in 2022 with seven local customer speakers, including NSE, Swiggy and Tata 1MG.

WHY IT WORKED

Invite-only lets field sales use the event as a deal step for named accounts. Back-to-back cities reuse one keynote, one demo set and one travelling team.

EVIDENCE

18 cities on the 2024 tour [company-reported](#). MongoDB has about 700 staff in India [third-party, Entrepreneur India](#). For contrast, Snowflake's open-registration Sydney stop saw about half of its 4,000+ registrants attend [third-party, InterWorks](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Make both round tables voucher-only, with GrowthSpree and the account team issuing codes per target GCC, and put a public "request an invite through your account team" page in front of them. Book one local customer speaker per city.

SOURCES

MongoDB, 2024 .local world tour; MongoDB.local Bengaluru FAQ; CXOToday, Sep 2022; Entrepreneur India, 2 Jul 2025

63. Confluent: Kafka Summit renamed for the category, then taken to Bengaluru (2016 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Kafka Summit started in San Francisco in 2016, named after the open-source project. In 2022 Confluent renamed it Current, widened it to all of data streaming, and kept Kafka Summit as a track. It held its first Bengaluru Kafka Summit in May 2024 and Current Bengaluru in March 2025, with Indian engineering speakers such as PhonePe and Dream11 on running at very large scale.

WHY IT WORKED

A category name draws people who don't use the product yet, and sponsors such as AWS and Databricks. Indian teams with very large workloads gave the India events peers the local audience respects.

EVIDENCE

Bengaluru 2024 had 2,500+ participants, in person and online [company-reported](#). Current Bengaluru 2025 listed 3,500+ attendees [third-party, in a promotional-style article](#). PhonePe runs about 400 billion messages a day [company-reported](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Name the round tables after the category, such as agentic SDLC, not OneFlux, so engineering heads using rival tools still come. Lead each city with one local "India scale" engineering story.

SOURCES

Confluent, Introducing Current, 25 Apr 2022; Confluent, Kafka Summit Bangalore 2024 recap; Analytics India Magazine, 3 Jul 2025

64. LeadDev: renting a room of VPs of Engineering (ongoing)

THE MOVE

Vendors pay LeadDev to host private, invite-only roundtables of about 15 senior engineering leaders. The sponsor opens briefly, LeadDev facilitates, attendees see each other's profiles in advance, and a LeadDev writer publishes an anonymised article from the session.

WHY IT WORKED

The vendor gets a room of buyers it couldn't gather alone, under a neutral host. Anonymity keeps people candid, and the write-up is reusable content.

EVIDENCE

About 15 per roundtable; 5,000+ event attendees a year across London, New York and Berlin; 86% of the audience have budget influence [company-reported](#). No sponsor pipeline data published.

COST

Not public.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Book one LeadDev-hosted VP Engineering roundtable in the US in the weeks before PlatformCon, and use its write-up as the reason to invite the same people to the SF dinner. Ask for profiles in advance so GrowthSpree can match them to target accounts.

SOURCES

[LeadDev roundtable FAQs](#); [LeadDev, plan your next campaign](#)

65. Reo.dev and Common Room: telling sales which accounts' engineers are already active (2023 to 2025)

THE MOVE

Reo.dev, founded in Bengaluru in 2023, turns developer activity (GitHub commits, package installs, docs visits, Docker pulls) into account-level buying signals. Common Room does the same across GitHub, social and community data. Pulumi's SDRs and Apollo GraphQL's AEs used these to find the account and buyer behind anonymous activity.

WHY IT WORKED

Enterprise devtool buying starts with engineers trying things long before a VP takes a call. Signal tools point outbound at accounts that are already warm.

EVIDENCE

DataHub reported \$1.01M of pipeline in a quarter from Reo.dev-identified accounts [company-reported, via press snippet](#). With Common Room, Apollo GraphQL got 26% of qualified leads in a quarter and Pulumi 27% of meetings booked [company-reported, vendor case studies](#). Reo.dev raised an \$11.3M Series A [third-party](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Instrument the docs, CLI and public repos before December, then rank GCCs by engineer activity and make that the round-table invite list and GrowthSpree's tier-1 list. It only works once there is public surface to measure.

SOURCES

[GlobeNewswire, Reo.Dev seed, 8 Oct 2025](#); [Common Room, Apollo GraphQL](#); [Common Room, Pulumi](#)

66. GitHub: a commissioned Forrester Total Economic Impact study as the CFO slide (2022 to 2025)

THE MOVE

GitHub paid Forrester Consulting for a Total Economic Impact model of GitHub Enterprise Cloud. Forrester interviewed five decision-makers at four organisations and modelled a composite 5,000-developer company. The result is an analyst-branded ROI, NPV and payback figure sales hands to finance.

WHY IT WORKED

Finance teams trust an analyst-firm number over a vendor calculator, and a composite lets a few customers stand in for a large one.

EVIDENCE

376% ROI, \$67.9M NPV and payback under six months for the composite, July 2025 company-reported, vendor-commissioned. \$48.3M of the benefit rests on a claim of saving developers about half their coding time company-reported.

COST

Not documented. The sample is small.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Line up four or five design partners now so a study like this can be built in 2027, with benefits split by Spec, Code, Review and On-call so each budget owner sees a line. Watch the single-claim dependency; a METR-style challenge would hit it.

SOURCES

Forrester TEI, GitHub Enterprise Cloud, Jul 2025; GitHub, 20 Dec 2022

67. Atlassian, GitHub, Snowflake and Pulumi: takeout packages built around a deadline (2023 to 2026)

THE MOVE

Before Server support ended in February 2024, Atlassian offered free cloud trials and credits; for the Data Center end of life it added FastShift, a free delivery manager, migration engineer and CSM for 1,000+ seat customers, in return for weekly check-ins and an executive sponsor. GitHub used the same deadline, extending its importers to Bitbucket Server and Bamboo and publishing a "the clock is ticking" post. Snowflake made its SnowConvert migration tool free to prospects in January 2025 after a short course, and Pulumi lets buyers apply HashiCorp credits they already bought toward Pulumi until renewal.

WHY IT WORKED

A hard date forces a decision, free named people remove the "migration takes a year" objection, and contract credits remove paying two vendors at once. The conditions (sponsor, course) qualify the buyer.

EVIDENCE

Atlassian Data Center to cloud migrations more than doubled year on year in Q1 FY26, and nearly half a million users went through FastShift's pilot company-reported. SnowConvert automates over 96% of code conversion company-reported. No published outcomes for GitHub's or Pulumi's counter-moves.

COST

FastShift is included with cloud purchase; other costs not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Copy FastShift's terms for GCC pilots: orgs with 1,000+ developers get a free named rollout team if they provide an executive sponsor and weekly check-ins. Keep a credit-for-unused-contract offer ready for when a rival coding assistant changes pricing.

SOURCES

Atlassian, 12 Sep 2023; Atlassian, What is FastShift; Atlassian Q1 FY26 letter; GitHub, 17 Oct 2023; Snowflake, 28 Jan 2025; Pulumi, 18 Dec 2025

68. MongoDB: AMP, selling modernisation as tool plus method plus engineers (2024 to 2025)

THE MOVE

MongoDB piloted legacy-application modernisation in 2024 combining AI code analysis, generated tests, its migration tool and professional services, then launched it in September 2025 as MongoDB AMP: an AI platform, a delivery framework and named delivery engineers. Launch references included Bendigo Bank, Lombard Odier and India's IntellectAI.

WHY IT WORKED

Enterprises won't buy AI that rewrites legacy code unless someone is accountable for the result. Packaging engineers with the tool turns an experiment into a project, and each project leaves a reference with a number.

EVIDENCE

More than 50% lower modernisation cost in pilots [company-reported, earnings call](#). Bendigo Bank cut a test run from 80+ hours to 5 minutes; Lombard Odier cut regression testing from 3 days to 3 hours [company-reported](#).

COST

Priced per engagement; not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Launch with one named, priced GCC package, such as "legacy service modernisation: OneFlux agents, a six-week method and two OneFlux engineers". Lead the launch film with a single before-and-after number from a design partner, the way MongoDB used 80 hours to 5 minutes. Pairs with entry 38.

SOURCES

[MongoDB, AMP launch, 16 Sep 2025](#); [Motley Fool, Q3 FY25 call, 9 Dec 2024](#)

13. Brand, dates and standards

69. Cloudflare: a launch date that matches the product, then a waitlist on the anniversary (2018, 2019)

THE MOVE

Cloudflare launched its 1.1.1.1 DNS resolver on 1 April 2018, because the address reads 4/1, and the launch post explained the date. A year later, on 1 April 2019, it announced the WARP app months before it was ready and ran a waitlist until September.

WHY IT WORKED

An April 1 launch makes people ask whether it's a joke, and the explanation travels with the story. An independent speed ranking and a promised privacy audit backed the claim.

EVIDENCE

About 14ms average response against 34.51ms for Google, per the independent DNSPerf monitor

[company-reported, citing third-party](#). About 2 million people joined the WARP waitlist [company-reported](#). 1.1.1.1 handles 1.9 trillion queries a day as of February 2025 [company-reported](#).

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Give 19 Jan a reason people can repeat, and reuse the date each year to ship the next agent. Announce one capability on launch day that isn't built yet, with a waitlist, so its count is the next story.

SOURCES

[Cloudflare, Announcing 1.1.1.1, 1 Apr 2018](#); [Cloudflare, WARP, 25 Sep 2019](#); [Cloudflare Radar, 27 Feb 2025](#)

70. GitHub: the Arctic Code Vault and a badge for every contributor (2019 to 2020)

THE MOVE

GitHub snapshotted every active public repository on 2 Feb 2020, wrote 21TB to 186 reels of archival film, and stored them in a decommissioned coal mine in Svalbard in July 2020. Every developer whose code went in got an "Arctic Code Vault Contributor" badge on their profile.

WHY IT WORKED

GitHub ran the stunt, but the badge put each developer's own name on it, so millions had a personal reason to share it at no media cost.

EVIDENCE

21TB on 186 reels [company-reported](#). No count of badge shares found.

COST

Not documented; about seven months from announcement to deposit.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Give every engineer in the launch-cohort teams a dated, verifiable credential, such as "first 1,000 specs shipped on OneFlux", made for LinkedIn, where GCC engineers share credentials. Tie it to something physical you can photograph, like a printed book of the first specs for the round tables.

SOURCES

[GitHub, 16 Jul 2020](#); [GitHub Archive Program](#)

71. Anthropic: the "Zero Slop Zone" pop-up and its "thinking" cap, with PostHog's merch bill as the guardrail (2025 to 2026)

THE MOVE

As part of Claude's first paid brand campaign, "Keep Thinking", Anthropic took over a New York newsstand for a week in October 2025. No screens: free coffee, books, pen and paper, and a plain cap embroidered "thinking", given only to visitors who showed the Claude app. In August 2026 PostHog published what its own merch programme costs and told startups not to copy it.

WHY IT WORKED

The merch was the message, one word against "AI slop", and requiring the app turned a giveaway into installs. PostHog's numbers show merch pays only when there's already an audience to amplify.

EVIDENCE

5,000+ visitors and 10M+ social impressions third-party, The Decoder and Adweek. PostHog spends about \$60K a month and 1.5 people on merch, with revenue "not enough to even mention", and once paid \$62.54 to ship a \$1 sticker to India company-reported.

COST

The pop-up's cost isn't disclosed; the campaign was "multi-million dollar" third-party.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Run a one-week café takeover in a Bengaluru or Hyderabad GCC cluster around 19 Jan, with one-word merch tied to the Spec idea, given in exchange for a workspace sign-up or a demo. Print in India and keep merch event-only; no global store.

SOURCES

[The Decoder](#), Oct 2025; [Axios](#), 18 Sep 2025; [PostHog](#), 25 Aug 2026

72. OpenAI and peers: AGENTS.md, a neutral file name as a standard (2025)

THE MOVE

In August 2025 OpenAI released AGENTS.md, a plain Markdown file that tells any coding agent how to build, test and follow a repo's conventions. It was developed with Amp, Google Jules, Cursor and Factory under a vendor-neutral name. In December 2025 OpenAI gave it to the Linux Foundation's new Agentic AI Foundation, alongside Anthropic's MCP.

WHY IT WORKED

Giving up the name let rivals adopt it without promoting a competitor, and each repo that adopts it shows the format to more developers. Foundation stewardship gave enterprises a reason to trust it long term.

EVIDENCE

20,000+ repositories by late August 2025 third-party, InfoQ; 60,000+ open-source projects by December 2025 company-reported, Linux Foundation.

COST

Not documented.

STEAL FOR ONEFLUX

Read AGENTS.md natively. Then propose one small open format for the part of the loop nobody owns yet, such as a spec or an on-call handoff file, under a neutral name; GCC platform teams approve a standard more easily than a vendor's format. This is the governed version of entry 8.

SOURCES

[agents.md](#); [InfoQ](#), 27 Aug 2025; [Linux Foundation](#), 9 Dec 2025

Fifteen moves that fit this leg

Each one fits the GTM-v2 calendar and needs little or no new money. Dates follow [plans/current/GTM-v2.md](#); none of this is approved.

#	MOVE	SLOT	OWNER AND BUDGET LINE	INSPIRED BY
1	Public weekly changelog in the website's top nav	From the 31 Oct website	Product and content; no spend	9
2	Design-partner waitlist, qualified by organisation and team size, count announced before launch	From 31 Oct; opens 19 Jan with pricing published	Website, GrowthSpree	12, 33
3	Measure OneFlux use inside Capillary now, and publish the number at launch	October onward	Product; no spend	11
4	"Spec with agents" workshops for GCC leaders, turned into a free, ungated method book and a method page	Workshops Nov to early Dec; publish 19 Jan	Content line; Goosewin prep block	24, 21
5	Thesis essay from a named engineering leader on why the loop closes at Spec	Early December, before the dead weeks of 21 and 28 Dec	Goosewin on X and LinkedIn	25, 23, 30
6	Agent-readable docs (llms.txt, Markdown, docs MCP) and a sandbox quickstart that works on first paste	With the December self-serve entry point	Goosewin docs and cookbook scope	4, 1, 3
7	Launch week from Tue 19 Jan, one module a day, features built behind flags in December, partner co-signed	19 to 23 Jan	Goosewin; launch media	7, 8
8	Open-source "how we run agents" manual under Apache 2.0, with a recipe library	Launch week	Content line	6, 18, 16
9	Shape the Research NXT survey so its headline gap is the one OneFlux closes, and map OneFlux metrics to DORA's four keys	Survey design now; report at the Bengaluru round table, 27 to 29 Jan	Research NXT SOW	40, 41, 42
10	Application-only round tables with a public seat cap, a closed VP session, seat cards and a channel per topic; a co-presented PlatformCon talk	Bengaluru 27 to 29 Jan, Hyderabad or Pune 9 to 12 Feb, SF 24 to 25 Feb	Research NXT; PlatformCon travel	30, 27, 29, 28

Ask Gartner, alongside these, which evaluations OneFlux could enter and when (entry 39). It costs nothing extra.

Five more from the second batch fit this leg as well:

#	MOVE	SLOT	OWNER AND BUDGET LINE	INSPIRED BY
11	AWS Marketplace listing with a private-offer template, including INR offers	Listed by 19 Jan	Commercial and finance; no media spend	48
12	Default attribution: a OneFlux co-author trailer, a PR footer and an On-call summary footer, each with an admin switch	December entry point	Product	52, 53
13	Voucher-only round tables named after the category, invite list ranked by engineer activity	Codes issued in December for the late January and February dates	Research NXT, GrowthSpree	62, 63, 65
14	Ten to twenty named GCC champions with funded meetups, and one India-only offer revealed at the round tables	Recruit in November	Influencer line	61, 59
15	One systems integrator as customer zero, with co-published usage	Sign before 19 Jan	Rohit, with Sales	50

Bigger bets for the April to March plan

- Free Review on public repos with a running counter (35, 5), funded at first from the reserve's subsidised-harness experiment if Review is in the launch scope.
- A forward-deployed engineering pod for the first ABM accounts (38).
- A newsletter for engineering managers (20), then a themed quarterly publication (19).
- A year-long sponsorship of one Indian engineering podcast or channel (26).
- An MCP-callable free tier so other agents trigger OneFlux runs (36, 34).
- A pre-registered randomised study with an outside lab (42).
- Azure Marketplace eligibility for GCCs on Microsoft agreements (48).
- A four-module certification with a named title and a country leaderboard (57, 56), and a Nasscom FutureSkills Prime course (58).
- A commissioned value study once four or five design partners are live (66).
- A priced modernisation package with named engineers (68).

What not to copy

- An unreproducible demo. Devin's Upwork video was debunked within weeks (10).
- Changing individual pricing after launch without notice. Cursor reversed and refunded (33).
- A licence change after adoption. HashiCorp's created OpenTofu (13). Cal.com closed its source in April 2026.
- Docs page views as the only way into the paid product. Tailwind lost most of its revenue when agents took the traffic (3).
- A developer paywall in an enterprise category. Snyk's "trickle" (37).

Appendix: what was discarded

Two research passes on 6 Oct 2026 looked at about 180 candidates. This appendix lists everything that didn't become an entry, so nothing has to be searched for twice. Numbers carry the same evidence tags as the main file; anything seen only in a search-result snippet is marked unverified. A candidate here isn't a bad idea. It failed one of four tests: a primary source, a documented outcome, a fit with an enterprise AI SDLC launch, or not repeating a stronger entry.

A. Sourced, but cut for fit

These had real numbers. They were cut because they suit a consumer or self-serve product, can't be planned, or a stronger entry already makes the point. Any could come back if the plan changes.

CANDIDATE	WHAT IT WAS	WHAT WAS FOUND	WHY IT WAS CUT	SOURCE
Supabase tagline (2020)	Homepage changed from "real-time Postgres" to "the open source Firebase alternative", then posted to Hacker News under that line	Hosted databases went from 8 to 800 in three days; the HN post got 1,100+ upvotes; 3K+ databases and about 5.5K stars by July 2020 third-party, Contrary	Naming the incumbent works best for a self-serve product with one obvious rival; OneFlux replaces several tools	Contrary Research, Aug 2024
BrowserStack word of mouth (2011 to 2018)	Mumbai founders posted where developers complained; jQuery's creator tweeted about it; no outside money or sales team for seven years	About 10,000 beta users in three weeks and 1,000 paying customers in six months; \$20M ARR in four years with about 50 people third-party . 25,000+ paying customers and 1.6M+ developers by 2018 third-party, TechCrunch	A lucky endorsement can't be planned; the lesson survives as entry 61's champions	TechCrunch, 30 Jan 2018
DigitalOcean Hacktoberfest (2014 to 2023)	October open-source month with community meetups and a t-shirt for finishers	India hosted 213 of 673 in-person events in 2019, Bengaluru first. Registrations fell from 146,891 (2022) to 98,855 (2023) after the t-shirt was dropped company-reported	Rewards open-source contribution, which OneFlux doesn't sell. Keep the lesson: any community month needs its reward budgeted from the start	DigitalOcean, 12 Nov 2019 ; DigitalOcean, 15 Nov 2023
Bolt.new (2024)	StackBlitz launched a prompt-to-app tool with a single tweet on 3 Oct 2024	\$0 to \$40M ARR in about five months with fewer than 40 staff third-party, Growth Unhinged	Consumer and prosumer audience; too close to Lovable	Growth Unhinged, 9 Jul 2025
Lovable ARR posts (2024 to 2025)	The CEO posted each revenue milestone and paired the \$100M post with a product launch	\$100M ARR at eight months, 2.3M active users, 180K paying, 45 staff third-party, TechCrunch	Enterprise buyers weigh ARR less. A usage number on a fixed cadence (specs merged, incidents closed) fits OneFlux better	TechCrunch, 23 Jul 2025
Lovable badge and Linkable (2024 to 2025)	"Edit with Lovable" badge on free-plan apps; a \$2 LinkedIn-to-website generator built with Lovable	About 20,000 Linkable sites in a few days unverified	Consumer audience; entries 52 and 53 make the attribution point for engineering buyers	Luca Mastella, 8 Apr 2025

CANDIDATE	WHAT IT WAS	WHAT WAS FOUND	WHY IT WAS CUT	SOURCE
GitKraken buys GitLens and a Jira app (2021 to 2022)	Bought the top free VS Code Git extension and the top paid Git app on the Atlassian Marketplace	GitLens had 11M active users and 71M downloads; the Jira app was used by 10,000+ companies company-reported . GitLens shows 53.1M installs third-party	Buying distribution isn't open to OneFlux before launch. Partnering with the top extension next to spec writing or review still is	Newswire , 8 Oct 2021; Resurgens , 16 Feb 2022
Supabase on the Vercel Marketplace (2024)	First-party integration: create a Supabase database from Vercel, billed by Vercel	Provisioning under 60 seconds; became Supabase's "largest partner channel" within weeks, no figures company-reported	Entries 48 and 49 make the "buy through the bill they already pay" point for enterprise	Supabase , 28 Aug 2024; Vercel , 7 Oct 2024
Datadog land and expand	Selling more products into existing accounts	55% of customers on four or more products by Q4 2025; net retention around 120% unverified, no primary source fetched	A product and pricing motion, not a marketing move	None kept
Tailscale bottom-up spread	Personal free use spreading into companies	5,000+ paying customers by March 2024, more than half added in the prior year unverified	Entry 34 covers the mechanism with a primary source	None kept
Supabase free tier	Generous free databases	1M+ databases and 2,500+ new a day in April 2024 unverified, snippets only	Entry 36 (Neon) makes the agent-provisioning point with a primary source	None kept
Postman State of the API	Annual open-access survey	Seventh edition in 2025, 5,700+ respondents company-reported	Same mechanism as entry 40, whose audience is closer to OneFlux's buyer	None kept
Stack Overflow developer survey	Survey sponsorship	2024: 65,000+ respondents; 76% using or planning to use AI; 43% trust its accuracy third-party	Sponsorship terms aren't public; useful as data, not as a move	None kept
Kubernetes the Hard Way	Kelsey Hightower's step-by-step tutorial repo	50,302 GitHub stars third-party, GitHub API	An individual Googler's project and widely known	None kept
Retool State of Internal Tools	Vendor survey	310 respondents in 2020 company-reported	Small sample and well known; entry 40 covers the pattern	None kept
Neo4j GraphAcademy	Free courses	200K learners company-reported	Nothing links it to adoption or revenue	None kept
ETHIndia and Devfolio	India hackathon platform	450+ projects in 2022; 950K builders across the platform company-reported	Crypto-specific audience	None kept
Databricks Data + AI World Tour	City roadshow	22 cities and 22,000+ attendees in 2025; 20 cities and 40,000+ expected in 2026 company-reported	No detail found on the executive-forum format; entry 62 covers city roadshows	None kept
Raycast	Product Hunt launch and extension store	#8 on Product Hunt in October 2020; 300 developers and 500+ extensions unverified	An ecosystem story, not a launch move	None kept
Arc browser	Invite-only waitlist	Waitlist dropped at 1.0 in July 2023; 500K+ on the Windows waitlist third-party, TechCrunch	No primary source on how the waitlist worked; used as a comparison in entry 12	TechCrunch , 11 Dec 2023
Codeium free extension	Free-forever individual tier in VS Code and JetBrains	1M, then 3M downloads company-reported	Its blog now sits under Cognition, and GitKraken covered the extension route	None kept

CANDIDATE	WHAT IT WAS	WHAT WAS FOUND	WHY IT WAS CUT	SOURCE
AWS Marketplace "AI Agents and Tools"	New category launched July 2025	900+ listings company-reported	No vendor outcomes yet; worth listing in, per entry 48	None kept
Cursor's early ARR	Growth before the enterprise push	\$4M in April 2024 to \$48M in October 2024 third-party, TechCrunch	The "no marketing, demo loop on X" story behind it has no primary source	None kept
GitHub Wrapped-style recaps	Graphite "Year in Code" and Remotion "GitHub Unwrapped" (Dec 2023)	Both real; the only number found was Rubric's 2021 GitHub Wrapped "scaled to 10k users" unverified	No usage figures for the 2023 versions	None kept

B. Real moves with no documented outcome

The move exists and was confirmed, but nothing showed what it achieved.

CANDIDATE	WHAT WAS CONFIRMED	WHY IT WAS CUT
Oxide Computer podcasts	"On the Metal" began late 2019; "Oxide and Friends" began as a Twitter Space on 3 May 2021 and passed 100 episodes by January 2024	No audience, customer or hiring outcome found
Honeycomb's o11ycon (2018)	A primary recap exists on dev.to	No attendance or business numbers
Datadog DASH	1,400+ workshops and sponsor counts published company-reported	No total attendance; thin mechanism
Datadog Summits	Customer-led city summits in London, Tokyo, Paris and Berlin	No numbers
HashiConf, GitHub Universe	Both run every year	Large first-party conferences without a mechanism a launch-stage team can copy; dbt and PlatformCon cover the pattern
Vercel Ship	Yearly conference: New York 2024, June 2025, five cities in 2026	No attendance figures or launch mechanics
OpenAI Codex launch	A livestream on 16 May 2025 and access staged by plan tier	No outcome numbers
Statsig SF billboards (2024)	200+ placements and the copy are documented	No results
Kilo Code SF billboard (Nov 2025)	The billboard ran	No placements, cost or results
Cloudflare Birthday Week, R2 (2021)	Launch confirmed	No waitlist or adoption numbers
Snowflake Partner Connect	Mechanism confirmed	No adoption number
Claude Integrations launch partners (May 2025)	Atlassian, Sentry, Linear and Cloudflare co-launched	No partner-side numbers
Turso and ThePrimeagen (Jan 2024)	A "fly Prime to Brazil" goal of 100 annual-plan signups through a tracked link	Outcome never published

CANDIDATE	WHAT WAS CONFIRMED	WHY IT WAS CUT
Creator sponsorships (Theo, Fireship, ThePrimeagen)	Sponsor lists and third-party rate estimates, such as \$3.5K to \$7.1K per video for Theo third-party, sponsorradar	No documented outcomes
Indian creators (Hitesh Choudhary, Striver)	Large audiences	No documented devtool sponsorship deals
Razorpay FTX hackathon	Free conference tickets for applicants	No participation numbers
Postman Student Experts (India)	"Thousands of students" and "hundreds certified"	No aggregate numbers, in either pass
Certifications: GitHub (Jan 2024), HashiCorp, Databricks, dbt, SnowPro	Programmes confirmed	No counts of people certified; entry 57 has the numbers
Snyk Advisor	A page for every npm package	No traffic data
Linear's early waitlist	General mentions of hand-picked users	No primary source or numbers
Warp's waitlist	Pricing pages only	No waitlist numbers
Tailscale and Railway Discord-first support	Communities exist	No numbers
Vercel and Netlify hobby tiers	Well known	No source tying the free tier to conversion
Cursor free Pro for students (May 2025)	Reported by third parties	Cursor's students page no longer shows the offer
Linear "magic words" GitHub integration	Mechanism documented	No numbers
Graphite stack comment on PRs	Comment exists	No growth source
Chromatic Storybooks, Figma Community files, "Open in Colab", Codecov badges, Gradio share links	All real share or embed loops	No counts found
shields.io badges	470M to 1.6B images a month, in fork READMEs only unverified	A nonprofit, and the figure is unsourced
Adaptavist ScriptRunner	Atlassian Marketplace app	Install and revenue claims only in snippets
Upstash powering Vercel KV (2023)	Partnership confirmed	No growth numbers; Context7 (entry 51) is stronger
incident.io Slack-native distribution	Slack-first product	No Slack directory numbers
Datadog on AWS Marketplace	A billion-dollar seller claim	Secondary snippet only

CANDIDATE	WHAT WAS CONFIRMED	WHY IT WAS CUT
Gremlin GameDays as a sales event	Product and how-to pages	No sales outcomes
Gifting to engineering leaders (Sendoso and similar)	Common practice	No devtool case study
Postman's usage-data enterprise motion	Job posts and "98% of the Fortune 500" claims	No primary source on how accounts are targeted
CTO dinner series (Dev.Pro and similar)	Run by services firms	No pipeline data
GitHub Copilot ROI calculators	Third-party calculators only	Folded into entry 66
Windsurf "Wave" release cadence	"Every 3.7 days"	The figure came from a blog of unclear origin
"Vibe coding" and "context engineering"	Collins Word of the Year 2025; Tobi Lütke's post on 18 Jun 2025 and Andrej Karpathy's on 25 Jun 2025	No company-level outcome from riding either term
llms.txt (Jeremy Howard, 3 Sep 2024)	About 844K sites in BuiltWith-type counts third-party	No major AI provider has confirmed using it, and SE Ranking found no link to AI citations; entry 4 covers agent-readable docs
LaunchDarkly and Harness category creation	A Forrester Wave "Strong Performer" mention (2024)	No primary source on analyst-led category coinage
Atlassian's no-sales-team model	Secondary blogs only	Runs opposite to an ABM-led enterprise launch
Gitpod's rebrand to Ona; Sourcegraph's enterprise pivot	Both happened	Not verified in time; the competitor guide covers Ona
Product Hunt launches	Common	No devtool case with signup numbers
Clerk's growth	"7% per week"	Origin of the figure unclear
Twilio docs, Supabase docs, PlanetScale docs	Docs-first reputations	No source tying the docs to an outcome
PostHog billboards and own ads	Listed as channels in the handbook	No source on specific stunts
Devtool direct mail or hardware drops	Anecdotes	No case study with numbers

C. Wrong premise, broken source, or now a warning

CANDIDATE	WHAT HAPPENED
The Pragmatic Engineer sponsorship	The newsletter takes no sponsors; only its podcast does. The idea was wrong from the start. Sponsor page

CANDIDATE	WHAT HAPPENED
Cal.com (open source as the sales deck)	Moved production code to closed source on 14 Apr 2026 over AI security concerns; the public code lives on as MIT-licensed Cal.diy without Teams or SSO. Now a warning, listed under "What not to copy". Implicator
Deno, "10 Things I Regret About Node.js" (2018)	Drew wide attention, but one source puts Deno at 1.9% usage against Node's 40.8% in Stack Overflow 2024 unverified . Reads more as a warning than a move.
Railway Help Station	"Railway Station" turned out to be Railway's internal app. A third-party tool, Answer Overflow, indexes Discord help channels, but no SEO effect could be verified.
launchweek.dev count	"122 launch weeks by 92 companies in 2024" appeared in a search summary; the page returned 404.
Loom shareable links	Not a devtool, and no conversion figures.

D. Folded into other entries

These were sourced and used, but as supporting evidence inside a stronger entry.

CANDIDATE	WHERE IT WENT
Puppet's State of DevOps report	Entry 41
METR's 2025 randomised trial	Counter-evidence in entry 42
OpenAI's SWE-bench Verified	Entry 43
Cloudflare's Workers vs Lambda latency tests	Entry 45
Gremlin's Chaos Conf	Entry 30
PostHog's handbook	Entry 18, alongside GitLab's
Supabase as open-source distribution	Entry 7 (Launch Week)
Arc's waitlist	Comparison in entry 12
Dependabot and Mend's Renovate	Entry 53
Netlify Deploy Previews	Entry 54
Netlify's deploy button and StackBlitz tutorials	Entry 55
Cognizant's record vibe-coding hackathon	Entry 50
Snowflake's India World Tour	Entry 62

CANDIDATE	WHERE IT WENT
Snowflake's One Million Minds and Nasscom FutureSkills Prime	Entry 58
Pulumi's HashiCorp credit offer and Snowflake's free SnowConvert	Entry 67
PostHog's merch costs	Entry 71
MCP as a standard (10,000+ published servers)	Entry 72; a "97M monthly SDK downloads" figure was found only on secondary sites
GitHub MCP Registry	Entry 51

E. Named but not researched to a source

Time ran out on these. They're starting points for a third pass, not findings.

- Docs and content: Docker, Dagger, Appwrite, Plausible, Vercel templates, Warp and Zed manifestos, Software Engineering Daily.
- Product loops: Raycast store, Warp Drive, Excalidraw, tldraw, Sentry and Datadog share links, RapidAPI, Readme.com, Mergify, CodeSandbox embeds, Gitpod and Codespaces buttons.
- Community and events: Replit bounties and hackathons, Figma free for education, JetBrains free for open source, Sourcegraph's free tier.
- Field and enterprise: GitLab "from Jenkins" and Datadog vs New Relic takeouts, JFrog swampUP, ElasticON Tour, GitHub Galaxy, Plato, customer advisory boards, AWS MAP-funded proofs of concept, Heroku add-ons, Stripe Apps.
- India: Hasura, Appsmith, Zoho Catalyst, Freshworks Refresh, GDG and I/O Extended, Microsoft Reactor Bengaluru, AWS Community Days India.